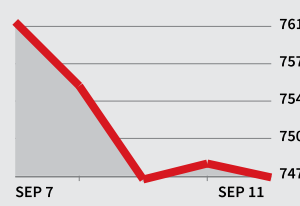


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 74781.76 (-120.83)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23398.10	-79.70
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	19.81	-0.03
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.55	+0.25
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	151330.00	-1343
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	228920.00	-4722

BOARDROOM FALLOUT.

Coforge Independent Director DK Singh resigns amid board tensions following Chairman OP Bhatt's controversial exit **p10**



AUTO FOCUS.

Simple Wave family electric scooter impresses with practicality and comfort **p4**

QUICKLY.

THE BIGGEST DEAL
India-EU FTA moves closer to landmark signing



New Delhi: The European Commission has formally put forward its proposal to the Council of the European Union for the signature and conclusion of the Free Trade Agreement (FTA) with India, moving the 'mother of all trade deals' a step closer to becoming the largest trade agreement either side has ever signed. **p10**

TO MOP-UP LIQUIDITY
RBI to sell ₹1-lakh crore of G-Secs in OMO auctions

Mumbai: The Reserve Bank of India on Friday announced the sale of Government of India securities (G-Secs) worth ₹1 lakh crore through open market operations (OMO) to manage liquidity conditions in the banking system. The sales will be conducted in three tranches: ₹50,000 crore on September 17, followed by ₹25,000 crore each on September 21 and 28 through multi-security auctions. **OUR BUREAU**

Modi, Putin focus on defence, trade ties ahead of BRICS meet

WIN WIN. Moscow pushes defence deals as Delhi looks to expand exports to narrow trade gap

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

In a bilateral meeting on Friday, Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Russian President Vladimir Putin talked about bolstering cooperation across trade, defence, energy and critical minerals. Aiming to hit \$100 billion in bilateral trade by 2030, India pressed for expanded exports to Russia to narrow its growing trade deficit.

The talks took place amid deepening geopolitical tensions, with conflict in West Asia and Ukraine continuing, and looming uncertainty over the US trade and tariff policies.

"Delighted to meet President Putin in Delhi, less than two weeks after our meeting in Bishkek. During today's meeting, we talked about closer trade ties, including the implementation of the programme for economic co-operation 2030 and cooperation in areas like infrastructure, energy, technology, defence, culture and more," Modi said on X following the meeting.

The meeting took place on the eve of the 18th BRICS



ALL-WEATHER FRIENDS. PM Narendra Modi and Russian President Vladimir Putin at a meeting in New Delhi on Friday **ANI**

Summit in New Delhi, which will be officially inaugurated on Saturday.

"The two leaders reviewed progress in bilateral cooperation in political, economic, defence, energy, space, skill mobility and people-to-people domains," according to a joint statement issued by the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) and the Russian Embassy in India.

TRADE DEFICIT

Broadening India's access to the Russian market was high on the PM's agenda as New Delhi looks to narrow a trade deficit of roughly \$50 billion, with Russian exports to India at about \$55 billion against imports of less than \$5 bil-

lion, a source pointed out.

"India wants to bring down the widening trade imbalance by increasing exports of pharmaceuticals, agricultural and food products, engineering goods and other manufactured products and wants Moscow to reduce both tariff and non-tariff barriers," an official noted.

Other areas of priority to India include cooperation in critical minerals, civil nuclear cooperation, including fuel cycle and life cycle support, cooperation in mobility and increasing Indian skilled labour to Russia and sustaining and increasing cooperation in fertilizers through strategic joint venture projects, the source added.

DEFENCE, KEY PILLAR

Defence remains a key pillar of the relationship, with Russia keen to deepen ties by supplying and producing in India Su-57 fifth-generation fighter jets, as well as upgrades to the BrahMos supersonic cruise missile system, as implied by Russian officials earlier. The \$100 billion trade target by 2030 was among the key points of discussion. India is also looking to expand industrial cooperation through Russia's first INNOPROM India exhibition, including collaboration in railways and tunnelling, development of the steel value chain and more business-to-business opportunities. The leaders also exchanged views on regional and global developments, including conflicts in West Asia and the Black Sea region.

The MEA statement said these conflicts "have impacted maritime trade and the safety and security of Indian seafarers".

"The Prime Minister reiterated that dialogue and diplomacy were the way forward in resolving conflicts and India stood ready to assist in peace efforts," the MEA said.

More reports on p2, p3

Need guardrails for AI systems that can influence real-world outcomes: FM

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Friday urged Indian regulators to adopt a soft-touch approach to regulating artificial intelligence (AI), while warning of the growing risks posed by increasingly autonomous AI systems capable of influencing real-world outcomes.

Speaking at the valedictory session of the Global Fintech Fest 2026, Sitharaman said recent reports from across the world highlight the ability of agentic AI systems to shape public opinion and potentially influence elections without the affected groups even being aware of it.

The Minister referred to warnings from a researcher, believed to be Jacob Coxon, who recently resigned from the AI company Anthropic, and raised concerns about self-improving AI systems and the long-term risks associated with superintelligence.

"I raise this not to cause alarm, but to emphasise institutional accountability towards the larger humanity. When an insider steps out on matters of safety and alignment, the public takes notice. Doubts voiced from within carry weight that external criticism never matches. Who from the global AI in-



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman at the Global Fintech Fest 2026 in Mumbai **ANI**

dustry will stand up and reassure the public? Who will demonstrate that safeguards are actually keeping pace with the speed? Where is the structured collective effort to provide credible and transparent answers?" she said.

GLOBAL SAFEGUARDS

Emphasising the need for stronger safeguards, Sitharaman noted that the cross-border nature of AI, fintech and digital platforms makes regulatory coordination increasingly important.

She said differences in regulatory frameworks are playing a bigger role in determining whether companies can enter foreign markets and compete on equal terms.

"The differences increasingly determine whether a company can enter a foreign market, operate successfully and compete on equal terms with domestic firms," she

said, adding that compliance with global regulations must become an integral part of Indian technology companies' growth strategies.

To strengthen India's global technology footprint, the Finance Minister proposed a federated industry platform bringing together start-ups and established technology firms. Such a platform could engage with foreign governments and regulators, promote interoperability standards, share best practices on data governance and cybersecurity, and help Indian firms navigate diverse licensing regimes while commercialising their intellectual property globally. She also urged global technology companies "to be fair to the jurisdictions where they earn their profits". "They need to treat those customers well, meet the tax obligations and give something back to the society that has made their success possible," she said.

Calling for greater oversight of AI deployment, she said regulators, boards and senior management must pay closer attention to how AI is used, the decisions it influences, the data it relies on and the risks it creates. "AI as a matter cannot be left entirely to the technology teams alone," she said.

GFF coverage on p7

NSE prices IPO at ₹1,700-1,785 targeting ₹22,000 crore; issue opens on September 17

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The National Stock Exchange's ₹22,000-crore-plus IPO, priced in the ₹1,700-1,785 band, against the Street expectation of over ₹2,000 per share, has prompted several existing shareholders to scale back their planned stake sale. Investors are eventually offering 12.64 crore shares, representing 5.11 per cent of the exchange's equity in the offer-for-sale (OFS).

STAKE SALE TRIMMED

At the lower end of the valuation, only 4.1-4.25 per cent of the NSE's equity need to be offered to meet regulatory norms, said Chief Executive Officer Ashishkumar Chauhan. The final OFS size



Ashishkumar Chauhan, Chief Executive Officer, NSE

is lower than the 14.89 crore shares proposed in the draft prospectus. The IPO is expected to raise ₹21,494-22,569 crore.

Several shareholders, led by SBI and MS Strategic (Mauritius), reduced their proposed stake sale at the RHP stage, while SBI Capital Markets joined the OFS with 87.8 lakh shares on offer, and Amit Kumar Lohia withdrew.

Other major investors, including CPPIB, Aranda Investments and a clutch of insurers, continue to participate.

"It was a challenge. It was harder to convince the selling shareholders to part with their stakes than to persuade incoming investors to invest," said an investment banker associated with the issue. The IPO is entirely an OFS, with no proceeds accruing to the NSE.

The public issue will open for subscription on September 17 and close on September 21. The allocation to anchor investors is scheduled for September 16, a day ahead of the issue opening.

As it prepares for listing, the NSE is looking to reduce its dependence on weekly index derivatives, which accounted for 46 per cent of

operating revenue in FY26. Transaction charges remain its largest revenue source, though their contribution has fallen to 70 per cent from 79 per cent five years ago.

NEW INCOME LINES

"New revenue streams such as data, connectivity and indices collectively account for almost 11 per cent of our revenue. These segments are growing at a very fast pace," Chauhan said, adding that "we hope to achieve even greater diversification going forward." The NSE is exploring new avenues, such as electronic gold receipts, specialised investment funds and ETFs, while planning to step up technology spending.

Chauhan said the exchange may later seek SEBI approval for NSE shares to trade on its own platform.

Anthropic report flags dangerous rise of weaponised AI

From fake dating sites to missile systems, LLMs being used for fraud and warfare

KV Kurmanath
Hyderabad

Artificial intelligence (AI) has evolved beyond chatbots and hacking tools into a potent engine for global cyber warfare and weapons development.

A chilling new report from Claude maker Anthropic reveals that threat actors are now weaponising advanced large language models (LLMs) in diverse ways. From fraudsters operating fake dating app networks to state-sponsored surveillance systems built to identify and monitor dissidents, the cases flagged in the report are many.

AI ARSENAL

A China-based operator used Claude to draft anti-torpedo system specifications, while another developed targeting software for electronic warfare and air defence suppression. In



CODED COMBAT. In Yemen, a weapons engineering group used AI to develop guidance software for rockets and missiles

Yemen, a weapons engineering group used it to develop guidance software for rocket and missile programmes.

In a disclosure about activities on Claude's platform between December 2025 and August 2026, Anthropic says hackers used AI to create automated monitoring agents that watch their own malware. When security products detected the malware, the agents modified and rebuilt it, repeating the process until

they could evade detection.

"Sophisticated and persistent threat actors test our safeguards and try to circumvent the technical measures we use to detect and prevent misuse," Anthropic said in the report, titled *Detecting and countering misuse of AI: September 2026*.

The company claimed that actors used Claude's Haiku, Sonnet and Opus models, not Fable or Mythos (except in one case), in the cases cited in

the report. Anthropic said it had disrupted the reported activities and used its findings to strengthen safeguards.

BIOSECURITY RISKS

Apeksha Kaushik, Senior Principal Analyst at Gartner, said the concern is not that AI independently creates a pathogen or toxin, but that it can support multiple stages of a harmful workflow, including research ideation, grant preparation, experimental planning, computational optimisation and concealing research objectives.

"This could reduce the time, cost and specialised knowledge required to develop credible proposals, enabling capable threat actors to work more efficiently and giving less-specialised threat actors access to information they may not previously have possessed," she said.

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LIC/P/2025-26/38/Eng

Modi champions UPI while Putin takes a swipe at G7’s sinking economic power

UNITED WE STAND. BRICS leaders’ session provides a collective voice for the bloc that accounts for 40% of the world’s GDP

Our Bureau
New Delhi

From Russian President Vladimir Putin taking a swipe at the G7 and Prime Minister Narendra Modi stressing on the importance of secure sea lanes for global trade and freedom of navigation amid choking of the Strait of Hormuz to Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian insisting on diversifying trade partners, sources of financing and payment channels, the BRICS leaders’ session on Friday provided a collective voice for the grouping that now accounts for 40 per cent of the world’s GDP.

Giving his concluding remarks, Prime Minister Modi talked at length about India developing new capabilities in strategic areas such as shipbuilding, semiconductors, critical minerals and its home-grown start-up revolution, but specifically, a speciality in India’s innovation story — the Unified Pay-



BUILDING A FUTURE. (from right) Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Russian President Vladimir Putin and Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian and other leaders and officials at the BRICS Business Forum and BRICS Women’s Business Alliance in New Delhi on Friday **REUTERS**

ment Interface — which can be adopted across countries. “UPI has given a new boost to financial inclusion and digital transaction on a population scale. Today, 50 per cent of the world’s real-time payments are on this technology. And, to create new solutions on this digital layer, we have given an open ecosystem to industries and start-ups. We are proud that

many countries are adopting India’s world-class ecosystem,” said Modi.

WEST ASIA WAR WOES Against the backdrop of disruptions in West Asia, PM Modi talked about security of seafarers and the need for supply routes to remain open. “Global trade progress is possible only when sea lanes are secure, supply

routes remain open and seafarers are safe. That is why India is such a staunch supporter of freedom of navigation and safety of seafarers,” he said. The Russian President drew a comparison between BRICS and G7, underlining that BRICS contributes more to the global economy. “Right now, the world is undergoing structural, deep,

profound shifts, which is explained by the fact that the so-called old leaders, which used to be the vanguard of economic growth in the second half of the 20th century, are being replaced by new engines of growth,” said Putin.

“The world is always changing, and this is attested to by the objective facts of the last five years. And I think these statistics have already been cited by our colleague from Indonesia. Over the last five years, more than 40 per cent of the world’s GDP has been produced by BRICS countries. Whereas the contribution of the so-called G7, I don’t know why they call that group of seven, stands at only 29 per cent. Now speaking about the growth of the world economy over the same period, we see that more than half of that growth has been accounted for by BRICS, whereas the G7 has only accounted for 18 per cent. Why is that? The answer is simple. BRICS countries account for more

than half of the world’s population, and that is why they have a great dynamic, vibrant domestic market,” said Putin.

ROLE OF BRICS The Iranian President talked about the ongoing geopolitical turmoil and how BRICS can play a positive role. “In recent months, Iran is facing military aggression from the US and the Israeli regime. This act of aggression, in addition to its human and material losses, once again reveals an important reality: that economic security cannot be separated from national and regional security. Whenever the trade, energy, infrastructure, or financial system of a country comes under political or military pressure, its effects extend beyond that country’s borders and can affect regional stability. BRICS must create an environment in which no country can disrupt the legitimate trade of another country,” said Pezeshkian.

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday met Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit, with the leaders discussing the situation in West Asia, the need for dialogue and diplomacy to resolve conflicts and ways to deepen bilateral cooperation.

SECOND MEETING The meeting was the second between Modi and Pezeshkian in less than two weeks. The leaders had met on August 31 on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Summit in Bishkek. The talks assume significance amid heightened tensions in West Asia and disruptions to energy and commercial flows in the region. Modi reiterated India’s consistent position that all issues should be resolved through dialogue and diplomacy, while underscoring the need for sustained efforts to ensure lasting peace and stability. The Prime Minister also stressed the importance of safeguarding freedom of navigation and commerce and the safety and wellbeing of seafarers, according to the government. The two leaders reviewed various aspects of India-Iran bilateral relations, and also discussed cooperation in multilateral forums, including BRICS. “Prime Minister thanked Iran for its regular, high-level participation in BRICS-related meetings despite the challenging circumstances. He noted the potential for BRICS in building the spirit of resilience, innovation, co-operation and sustainability among countries in the Global South. He also thanked President

During the meeting, the Iranian President pitched for greater use of local currencies in trade among BRICS members

Pezeshkian for his participation in the leaders’ session of the BRICS Business Forum,” said the Ministry of External Affairs following the bilateral meeting. “The two leaders exchanged views on recent developments in West Asia. Prime Minister reiterated India’s consistent position that all issues must be resolved through dialogue and diplomacy. He also underscored the need for continued efforts to ensure lasting peace and stability in the region, safeguarding freedom of navigation and commerce and the safety and wellbeing of seafarers,” said the MEA.

CRITICAL TIME Pezeshkian’s visit to New Delhi is his first as Iranian President and comes at a particularly sensitive juncture for the region. Before his arrival, he had emphasised the need for BRICS to strengthen economic resilience and reduce dependence on the US dollar. Speaking at the leaders’ session of the BRICS Summit, Pezeshkian pitched for greater use of local currencies in trade among BRICS members, arguing that this would make intra-bloc commerce less vulnerable to political and economic shocks. He called for mechanisms to facilitate national currency settlements and manage currency risks as part of a broader push to deepen economic integration among BRICS countries.

FMs and central bank governors flag unilateral trade actions

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Finance Ministers and central bank Governors of BRICS member countries have expressed serious concerns over the unilateral imposition of trade and finance-related actions.

They called for the implementation of increased quota in the International Monetary Fund. These are part of the joint statement, issued after two rounds of the meeting of Finance Ministers and Central Bank Governors (FMCBG) of BRICS countries, held in Jaipur and Mumbai. Accord-

ing to the statement, the global economy is facing significant headwinds.

ECONOMIC OUTLOOK Risks to the global economic outlook remain elevated, reflecting persistent geopolitical tensions, trade fragmentation and protectionism, policy uncertainty, fiscal and inflationary pressures, growing debt and financial vulnerabilities. “We continue to have serious concerns over the unilateral imposition of trade and finance-related actions, including the raising of tariffs and non-tariff measures, which distort trade and are inconsistent with World

They also called for the implementation of increased quota in the International Monetary Fund

Trade Organisation (WTO) rules,” it said.

EMERGING MARKETS Further, these pressures weigh most heavily on Emerging Markets and Developing Economies (EMDEs). BRICS economies, however, have demonstrated resili-

ence and continue to make a significant contribution to a sustainable, inclusive and balanced global growth.

In this context, “we will strengthen our collective efforts to enhance global economic resilience, sustain investment and growth and preserve an open and inclusive global economic environment,” the statement said.

It highlighted the need for mobilising development finance, reaffirming the role of multilateralism, strengthening international financial cooperation, supporting infrastructure and productive investment and harnessing trade, innovation and technology, with particular at-

tention to the needs of EM-DEs.

“We reiterate our support for an open, transparent, inclusive, non-discriminatory, and rules-based multilateral trading system with the WTO at its core,” the statement said.

CALL FOR REFORMS Emphasising the need for further reforms of multilateral agencies, such as the World Bank and IMF, the statement reiterated the urgent need to reform the Bretton Woods Institutions (BWI) to make them more agile, effective, credible, inclusive, fit for purpose, unbiased, accountable and rep-

resentative to enhance legitimacy. “We also reiterate our call for improved management procedures, including through a merit-based, inclusive and transparent selection process that would increase regional diversity and representation of EMDEs in the leadership of the IMF and the World Bank,” it said. The statement reaffirmed the BRICS Rio de Janeiro Vision for IMF quota and governance reform, and the need for a strong, quota-based and adequately resourced IMF at the centre of the global financial safety net to effectively support its members.

Modi gifts ancient Tamil classic *Thirukkural* to Putin



CULTURAL DIPLOMACY. Modi presenting Russian President Vladimir Putin with a translation of Tamil classic *Thirukkural*

Our Bureau
New Delhi

On the sidelines of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi, Prime Minister Narendra Modi presented Russian President Vladimir Putin with a Russian translation of the ancient Tamil classic *Thirukkural*.

Published in 2026 by the Central Institute of Classical Tamil, the edition features original Tamil verses, alongside transliterations and a

translation by Naira Mkrtchyan. Composed by the poet-philosopher Thiruvalluvar, between 300 BCE and 500 CE, the work consists of 1,330 couplets covering virtue, statecraft and love, offering timeless wisdom on governance and ethics that Modi leveraged to highlight India’s rich literary tradition. The diplomatic gesture underscores a historic cultural connection between India and Russia that dates back centuries.

‘Unified payment system achievable with right trust framework’

bl.interview

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

A unified payment system for the 11-member BRICS bloc is achievable with the right trust and regulatory framework, while affordable connectivity remains key to bridging the global digital divide, said Ziaad Suleiman, Chair for the Digital Economy Working Group, South Africa Chapter, BRICS Business Council. Suleiman, who is attending the BRICS business forum, talks about digital payments, local currencies, connectivity and technology.

How feasible is it for BRICS countries to establish a unified payment system, and what are the key challenges that need to be addressed? A unified payment system for BRICS is certainly

The starting point is connectivity, because if you don’t have connectivity and people are not connected to the digital economy, then there is no transaction

ZIAAD SULEIMAN
Chair for the Digital Economy Working Group, South Africa Chapter, BRICS Business Council

achievable. What we need is the right level of trust and an appropriate framework. Once countries establish the necessary safeguards and understand how businesses operate in each other’s markets, including the parameters for trust and security, such a system can become a reality. Without these safeguards, countries will naturally have concerns about whether



their data is safe and whether transactions are secure.

When we talk about using local currencies for trade, banking systems can be a challenge, apart from the issue of trust. What needs to be done to strengthen or scale up banking systems in individual BRICS countries to support a

unified payment system? I think it’s about choice. It’s about multilateral agreements. It’s about deciding which is their currency of trade. And, obviously, each country would want to be trading in its own local currency. So, if that becomes an issue, again it comes down to trust and what the agreements are. I don’t think there’s a simple answer, to be quite honest, because I think it depends on the level of trade and the relationships. But, ultimately, if you have this, then you’re able to get cross-border remittances to work. **A major hurdle to digital transformation in the Global South is the digital divide and the high cost of connectivity. Can BRICS cooperation be translated into tangible digital infrastructure that can be shared or accessed by member**

countries, helping them bridge this gap before moving to more advanced technologies such as AI? Look, the starting point is really connectivity, because if you don’t have connectivity and people are not connected to the digital economy, then there is no transaction, right? So, that’s the starting point. And when you look at that, then ultimately it comes down to which countries have what level of connectivity. And, as I said earlier, there are different forms of connectivity. 5G is one, which is most reliable, but ultimately, there are other forms, too. When you look at peri-urban and rural areas, there we have to rely on satellite and other forms. Because, to your point, how do you actually serve the underserved? And then the issue becomes affordability and accessibility. And, when you look at it, that really is how those people transact; it

has to be at the right price point. **The digital landscape is currently dominated by US and Chinese tech giants. From a South African and broader developing country perspective, how can local innovators and start-ups realistically compete in this environment, and what kind of leverage can BRICS provide?** South Africa has an agnostic view on technology. For us, we are open to trade and are open to working with all partners. Our economy is heavily centred on multiple multinationals and OEMs and, therefore, it’s all about fit-for-purpose. You have to see what’s the objective you’re trying to solve, and based on the objective, what’s the best solution to service that. And I think when you look at those nuances, then you get the answer.

India can scale exports worth \$200 billion to BRICS by 2030, says Assocham report

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Indian companies are set to benefit across engineering, automobile, electronics, pharma, textiles, agriculture, renewables and digital services, as trade with BRICS has grown significantly during the last five years from \$203 billion in 2020-21 to \$417 billion in 2025-26, said a report on Friday. According to a research report by industry body Assocham and Global Research and Strategy Centre, titled *The Rise of BRICS Nations: An opportunity to scale Indian Exports to \$200 billion to BRICS by 2030*, trade dynamics are influenced by

various factors, including the economic performance of the BRICS+ countries, their trade policies and the global economic landscape. For India, the opportunity is not only to export more to BRICS+ countries, but to strengthen its production, sourcing and value chains, technologies, settlement systems, along with the opportunity to learn from the best practices and ecosystems that have been developed across these economies, the report said. “BRICS has emerged as an important platform for co-operation among major emerging economies and is assuring a growing role in shaping the global economic landscape... The objective of



RIGHT PATH. BRICS provides an important avenue for strengthening economic partnerships

scaling India’s exports to BRICS countries to \$200 billion by 2030 is, therefore,

both timely and ambitious. There is considerable potential to identify emerging

areas of demand, address trade barriers, strengthen value-added exports and

build stronger business-to-business linkages across BRICS markets,” said Piyush Goyal, Commerce and Industry Minister, in the report. **ECONOMIC TIES** At a time when global trade and investment are undergoing significant transformation, BRICS provides an important avenue for strengthening economic partnerships, deepening trade and investment linkages, promoting resilient supply chains and advancing cooperation across diverse areas of mutual interest, he added. Among the major emerging economies, India witnessed an average GDP

growth of more than 7 per cent during the last five financial years (2021-26). Even in the first quarter of the current fiscal year, Indian economy recorded 7.8 per cent growth. As the fastest-growing major economy, India can play a pivotal role in broadening the bloc’s horizons and facilitating a co-ordinated approach to resolving challenges arising from global geopolitical and economic developments. “The BRICS grouping, representing approximately 40 per cent of global GDP, 26 per cent of world trade and nearly 50 per cent of the global population, has become an important pivot in the global economy. With its expanded membership and

growing influence, it offers new opportunities for trade, investment, technology co-operation and sustainable development. As the global economy continues to evolve, stronger engagement among BRICS nations can support growth, resilience and economic diversification,” said Nirmal Kumar Minda, President, Assocham.

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India calls for trade in local currencies, linking payment systems across BRICS

STRATEGIC PRIORITIES. Alternative global financial system has become Moscow’s key leverage: Russian Minister

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

India on Friday pushed for greater digital and financial integration among BRICS economies, including linking of payment systems and trade in local currencies, while calling for greater economic resilience, self-reliance, diversified supply chains and easier market access amid growing geopolitical uncertainties.

Addressing the inaugural session of the BRICS Business Forum in New Delhi, Commerce & Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said India’s digital payment interface today has over 250 billion transactions a year, representing more than half of the transactions by volume across the world, and was accepted in 11 countries.

LINKING PAYMENTS
“I would urge the BRICS member countries and partner countries to link our payment systems, trade in each other’s local currencies, make digital trade global, and build together for the future emerging clouds,” he said.

The BRICS Business Forum, which brought together businesses, entrepreneurs and industry representatives from member countries to identify commercial opportunities and address barriers to economic co-operation, took place amid heightened global uncertainty triggered by geopolitical conflicts, the West Asia crisis and a rapidly changing tariff landscape following US President Donald Trump’s trade measures. The forum was held on the eve of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi.

BRICS members include Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, the UAE, Saudi Arabia and Indonesia.

Russian Economic Development Minister Maxim Reshetnikov, who spoke at the forum, said that an alternative international financial system had become Moscow’s key leverage. “Today, it links thousands of banks from many countries, and prospects are even greater. Positive dynamics would not come true without specific mechanisms,” he said.

Russia is seeking greater



TRADE PUSH. (From left) Russian Economic Development Minister Maxim Reshetnikov, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar and Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal at the opening ceremony of the BRICS Business Forum 2026 in New Delhi

foreign investment and highlighted the restructuring of its trade towards “friendly partners”, which now account for about 85 per cent of its total trade turnover, he added.

GREATER SELF-RELIANCE
Commenting on the increasingly unpredictable global situation, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said the global political and economic order was under stress, making resilience a central challenge for economies. “For BRICS particularly, higher economic activity, higher economic security means greater self-reliance,” he said.

Jaishankar said the object-

ive should be to strengthen the ability of BRICS economies to absorb shocks while remaining connected to the global economy. This, he said, required genuine market practices, dependable logistics, predictable business environments, diversified commercial access, and transparent regulation and investment.

“It also calls for energy systems capable of coping with disruption and transition pathways which are suited to different national circumstances,” the Minister said.

He also underlined the growing importance of technology in economic and geopolitical affairs. Digital pub-

lic infrastructure, artificial intelligence, fintech and advanced manufacturing offered major opportunities, but also raised issues relating to access, standards, security and trust.

MARKET ACCESS
Goyal called for BRICS members and partner countries to make market access easier by addressing regulatory and non-tariff barriers and strengthening supply-chain resilience.

He urged BRICS countries to open their markets to each other’s products, including raw materials and critical minerals, and to simplify regulatory procedures and facilitate faster clearances.

“Let us open our services markets for each other in the real sense,” Goyal said, calling for easier movement of professionals and greater recognition of professional bodies across borders.

Goyal said BRICS had significant capabilities across agriculture, pharmaceuticals, engineering, electronics, automobiles and auto components and services, creating scope for joint innovation, tech partnerships and resilient global value chains.

Major scope for India-Russia CBDC trade settlements: Sberbank CEO

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Russia’s largest bank Sberbank on Friday said that it sees major opportunities for India-Russia bilateral trade settlements through central bank digital currencies (CBDCs). The bank also plans to open 10 branches in India.

At a media briefing here, Sberbank CEO Herman Gref said trade settlement in CBDCs is much more efficient. Further, he said, the bank has been using surplus rupees to support liquidity, including investments in Indian government securities.

ON BILATERAL TIES
Talking about bilateral trade settlement in rupee terms, Gref said, “Our system is now working more efficiently than before. Last year, we had a problem of surplus rupee, but there is no such issue this year.”

Currently, the bank is operating in India on a branch model with offices in New Delhi and Mumbai. Now, to expand its presence in India, Sber has acquired two buildings, which are under construction and will be commissioned in 2028.

In central Delhi, the bank will create not only its own headquarters but also a business centre for major Rus-



Sberbank CEO Herman Gref

sian and Indian companies, developing business cooperation between Russia and India. The total area of the complex will be 48,000 sq m.

The project has become the largest Russian investment in India’s commercial real estate market. It will provide high-class offices for companies operating in the region.

LICENCES SOUGHT
The bank has sought 10 branch licences from the RBI across 10 cities. “We are awaiting approval from the local regulator,” Gref said.

Asked if the bank is planning to convert into a wholly-owned subsidiary, he said: “There is no immediate plan.”

On promoting investment, Gref said recently the bank had launched a product for account holders to invest in Nifty 50 stocks. Besides, he said it will also seek the right partners to bring new technology in high tech, education and healthcare.

Sberbank is also interested in partnerships and participation in largescale infrastructure projects in India.

TWO PLATFORMS
Sberbank announced the launch of two specialised platforms for business in both countries. One of them is a recruitment platform that brings together Russian and Indian agencies and government services. Its goal is to attract Indian specialists to the Russian market, which is experiencing an acute shortage of personnel. In addition, the project will promote cultural exchange and strengthen business ties.

The second is an IT platform for finding partners, developed jointly with major Indian companies. It will provide Indian businesses with all the necessary information about opportunities in the Russian market, regulatory frameworks and potential partners.

According to the bank, the main task is to create a digital ecosystem for companies in both countries and balance the trade deficit. Currently, the imbalance is about \$50 billion in Russia’s favour.

Gref emphasised that the bank is interested in partnerships with India in financial services, technology, education and healthcare.

‘India, Russia on track to surpass \$100 b bilateral trade target by 2030’

bl.interview

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

As leaders and trade delegations converge in New Delhi for the BRICS Summit, economic cooperation between India and Russia has taken centre stage, with a sizeable Russian business delegation accompanying President Vladimir Putin.

Vladimir Padalko, Vice-President, Chamber of Commerce and Industry of the Russian Federation, and a prominent member of the visiting delegation, discusses India-Russia economic ties, including efforts to diversify trade beyond conventional sectors such as oil and gas, facilitating local currency payments and expanding bilateral commerce well beyond the \$100 billion target.

Edited excerpts:

What is the main focus of the Russian business delegation’s visit during the BRICS Summit?
First of all, we are very impressed by the situation in the Indian economy. We are bringing to Bharat our investments and technologies, and we would certainly like to increase the overall volume of collaboration between our countries. Today, our Russian delegation consists of more than 1,000 people representing over 100 big and small enterprises.

India has been worried about its rising trade deficit with Russia. What are the products and sectors where Russia can increase



We are historically friends and partners, and every Russian knows that our friendship is timeless

VLADIMIR PADALCO
Vice-President, Chamber of Commerce and Industry of the Russian Federation

imports from India?
While we understand the current dynamics of our bilateral and foreign trade, we recognise that we need to increase imports from Bharat to Russia, and we know we have the real capabilities to do so. That is why we are ready to direct our resources towards the transport and logistics sectors first, while also increasing collaboration in the digital sphere. As you know, we are already deeply engaged in oil and gas, but we want to further diversify our partnership into areas like railways and the broader real economy.

Yesterday, our Trade Minister highlighted the possibility of growing India’s exports in sectors such as pharmaceuticals, food products, engineering goods and textiles. Will that happen?
Absolutely. We were very much struck by the speech

delivered by Minister Piyush Goyal, and we will do our absolute best from our side to follow through and align our efforts with his recommendations.

There was a time when cross-border payments were a major challenge for India-Russia trade. How do you see the payment system evolving, particularly with the increasing use of local currencies?
Currently, we do not have any difficulties regarding cross-border payments between our nations. Frankly speaking, our transactions are processed very quickly in both countries. While we are entirely ready to conduct business using our national currencies, we are certainly not opposed to utilising the dollar, euro or any other currencies if needed.

Given the geopolitical tensions and the uncertainty created by US tariffs, how important is it for Indian and Russian businesses to strengthen their partnership? Is the \$100 billion bilateral trade target by 2030 feasible?
We are historically friends and partners, and every Russian knows that our friendship is timeless. You must remember that the largest market in the world today is the Global South, which is why our shared philosophy and nature form the strongest possible foundation for our relationship. Looking ahead, I believe we will surpass the \$100-billion trade target within the next two to three years, and by 2030, the figure will be significantly higher.

‘Critical minerals are a key focus at the Summit’

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Coal and Mines Minister G Kishan Reddy said on Friday that critical minerals are among the key discussion topics at the 18th BRICS Summit.

Speaking on the sidelines of the CII Summit on Advanced Materials, Critical Minerals and Metals, the Minister said, “Critical minerals are an important segment not just for India, but also globally. Nations are discussing this issue. In the BRICS summit, one of the major agenda is discussion on critical minerals.

“Yesterday, I met Anton Alikhanov, Russia’s Minister of Industry and Trade. I will



Coal Minister G Kishan Reddy

also meet other nations.”

Reddy and Alikhanov discussed strengthening India-Russia co-operation in critical minerals.

The deliberations included building resilient supply chains, promoting technology and investment and advancing cooperation

in the mining sector. The Minister also highlighted that under the National Critical Mineral Mission (NCMM), the Geological Survey of India (GSI) had taken up 300 critical mineral exploration projects in 2026 alone, and four critical mineral processing parks are being developed with Gujarat, Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh and Odisha.

India has acquired five lithium blocks in Argentina and entered into partnerships with Japan, Peru, the UK and the US, he added.

Jitendra Singh, Minister of Science and Technology, said: “The next phase of technological competition is essentially going to have critical minerals as a very important component.”

HITACHI

Hitachi Energy India Limited

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NOTICE OF POSTAL BALLOT AND E-VOTING INFORMATION

NOTICE is hereby given pursuant to the provisions of Section 108, 110 and other applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013, (the ‘Act’), read with Rule 20 and 22 of Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, as amended, in accordance with the requirements prescribed by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs for holding General Meeting/ conducting Postal Ballot process through e-voting vide General Circular Nos. 14/2020 dated April 08, 2020, 17/2020 dated April 13, 2020, 20/2020 dated May 05, 2020, read with other relevant circulars issued in this regard, the latest being General Circular No. 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 and other relevant circulars issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (‘MCA Circulars’), Regulation 44 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 and Secretarial Standard on General Meeting (‘SS-2’) issued by Institute of Company Secretaries of India (‘ICSI’), approval of the Members of Hitachi Energy India Limited (‘the Company’) is being sought on the following Ordinary Resolutions through Postal Ballot, by way of electronic means (‘remote e-voting’) only:

Sl. No.	Description of Ordinary Resolution
1	Approval of Material Related Party Transactions with Hitachi Energy Sweden AB
2	Approval of Material Related Party Transactions with Hitachi Energy USA Inc
3	Approval of Material Related Party Transactions with Hitachi Energy Ltd., Switzerland

In compliance with the MCA Circulars, the Company has sent the Postal Ballot Notice on September 11, 2026, only through electronic mode, to those Members of the Company whose names appeared in the Register of Members/ List of Beneficial Owners as maintained by the Company/ Depositories, respectively as at close of business hours on Friday, September 04, 2026 (the ‘Cut-off date’). Accordingly, the requirement of sending physical copy of the Notice, postal ballot forms and pre-paid business reply envelopes has been dispensed with. The Postal Ballot Notice is available on the Company’s website at <https://www.hitachienergy.com/in/en/investor-relations/general-meetings#postal-ballot> websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e., BSE at: www.bseindia.com and NSE at: www.nseindia.com and on the website of KFinTech at: <https://evoting.kfintech.com>.

Members who have not updated their e-mail address, are requested to register the same with their respective depository participant(s) in respect of shares held in electronic form and in respect of shares held in physical form, are requested to submit the duly executed ISR Forms and send their request to our RTA at below mentioned address for receiving all the communications including annual report, notices, letters, etc., in electronic mode from the Company:

KFin Technologies Limited (Unit: Hitachi Energy India Limited), Selenium Tower B, Plot Nos. 31-32, Financial District, Nanakramguda, Gachibowli, Serilingampally Mandal, Hyderabad - 500032, E-mail ID: einward.ris@kfintech.com.

The Company has engaged the services of KFin Technologies Limited (‘KFinTech’) to provide remote e-voting facility to its Members. The remote e-voting shall commence on Sunday, September 13, 2026, at 9:00 a.m. (IST) and shall end on Monday, October 12, 2026, at 5:00 p.m. (IST). The remote e-voting module shall be disabled by KFinTech for voting thereafter.

The instructions for the manner of e-voting are provided in the Notice of Postal Ballot for Members who have registered their e-mail address and also for those Members who hold shares in physical form or who have not registered their e-mail address.

In case of any queries, Members may write to Company Secretary at the registered E-mail ID: investors@hitachienergy.com or may refer to the Help & Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) and E-voting user manual available at the download section of <https://evoting.kfintech.com> (KFinTech Website) or contact Ms. C Shobha Anand, Vice President, KFinTech at Selenium, Tower B, Plot Nos. 31-32, Financial District, Nanakramguda, Gachibowli, Serilingampally Mandal, Hyderabad - 500032 or at evoting@kfintech.com or call **KFinTech’s toll free No. 1800-3094-001** for any further clarifications.

The Board of Directors of the Company has appointed Mr. Pramod S. M., (Membership No. FCS 7834/CP No. PCS 13784), Practicing Company Secretary, Bengaluru and in his absence Mr. Biswajit Ghosh (Membership No. FCS 8750/CP No. PCS 8239), Practicing Company Secretary, Bengaluru, as the Scrutinizer to scrutinize the Postal Ballot process in a fair and transparent manner.

The Scrutinizer will submit his report to the Chairman, or any other person authorized by him, after scrutiny of the votes cast, on the result of the Postal Ballot on or before Wednesday, October 14, 2026. The Scrutinizer’s decision on the validity of votes cast will be final.

The Resolution, if passed by the requisite majority through Postal Ballot by remote e-voting, will be deemed to have been passed on the last date specified for e-voting i.e., Monday, October 12, 2026. The results declared along with the Scrutinizer’s Report shall be placed on the Company’s website: <https://www.hitachienergy.com/in/en/investor-relations> and on the website of **KFin Technologies Limited**: <https://evoting.kfintech.com/> and also be communicated to BSE Limited and the National Stock Exchange of India Limited where the equity shares of the Company are listed, on or before Wednesday, October 14, 2026. Additionally, the results shall also be displayed on the notice board at the Registered Office of the Company.

For Hitachi Energy India Limited

Sd/-
Poovanna Ammatanda
General Counsel & Company Secretary
FCS-4741

Place: Bengaluru
Date : September 11, 2026

QUICKLY.

Maruti Baleno launched at ₹5.99 lakh, ex-showroom



Maruti Suzuki's popular full-size hatchback, the Baleno, has received a comprehensive update. Aside from revised front-end styling that marks a strong departure from its predecessor, the new Baleno replaces its K-Series four-cylinder petrol engine with a Z-Series 1.2-litre three-cylinder engine. Among its many feature additions is Level 2 ADAS, a first for the Baleno, and as earlier, you can have one in a factory-fitted CNG variant as well. Introductory prices range from ₹5.99 lakh to ₹9.99 lakh (ex-showroom).

Royal Enfield adds the Himalayan 440 to its lineup



Marking a decade of the Himalayan adventure motorcycle, Royal Enfield has revived the original Himalayan, albeit with a 440 cc 25-bhp engine and 6-speed transmission borrowed from the Scram. Launched at ₹2.29 lakh (ex-showroom), the Himalayan 440 is only being offered in one variant and three colour options. Equipped with analogue instrumentation, a 21/17-inch front/rear wheel combination and a 15-litre tank, the Himalayan 440 spells great news for fans of the erstwhile 411.

BMW i5 LWB electric sedan makes its India debut



BMW's first-ever locally assembled electric sedan in India is the i5 eDrive 35L M Sport, and it's been launched at an introductory price of ₹79.6 lakh (ex-showroom). The i5 LWB features an 81.6-kWh battery pack with 669 km of range (MIDC) and 160-kW DC charging capability that allows for 10-80 per cent charge in a claimed 33 minutes. In this spec, it gets a single electric motor that produces 264.4 bhp and 41.8 kg-m of torque.

@TheMotorGram



RUMAN DEVMANE

Ruman Devmane

The bright red scooter you see here is called the Wave. It's made by Simple Energy, the maker of the One and the Ultra, both sporty scooters. The Wave is its idea of a family EV and, therefore, was made to a simple brief. It had to be pretty, plush and practical. All of which it is.

At its very core, the Wave is a fairly well-specced scooter. You can have one in four battery capacities spread across six variants. The one I rode was the 3.7-kWh version, but you can have one with 2.2-kWh, 2.7-kWh and 5-kWh options as well. There are two motors on offer — 4.5 kW and 6.4 kW — with the smallest being exclusive to the base Wave S variant. The IDC range varies between 110 km and 243 km (171 km for the 3.7-kWh version we sampled), in ascending order of the available variants. The most affordable of the lot is priced ₹1.09 lakh (introductory, ex-showroom), while the top-end version is priced ₹1.89 lakh. Our test bike, the 3.7-kWh version with a TFT screen, came wearing a ₹1.59 lakh price tag. Steep, eh?

FAMILY MATTERS

Anyway, let's dive into the details. It looks the way it does because it's meant to appear appetising to the new-age family. Yes, it does appear exaggeratedly elongated and I think it looks better in person than in photographs. Space management is at an all-time high, too, what with that enormous 66-litre underseat boot, the apron storage compartment, the standard four-litre 'pill' storage integrated into the side panel (remember the lockable storage on an old Bajaj Super/Chetak?) and the option to have one on the

other side as well, as a paid extra. Structurally, the Wave has all the makings of a good family scooter, too. There's a telescopic fork, two shock absorbers, an uncomplicated tubular swingarm and even a chain-drive system with a rubber-lined sprocket. The chassis isn't a carry-over from the sporty One/Ultra, and with a kerb weight ranging between 121 kg and 128 kg (124.5 kg for the 3.7), it's pretty light. Keeping in mind its 'family' orientation, it rightfully features a 775-mm seat height and an appropriately low-set handlebar as well.

The floorboard appears rather wide, too, but I don't think it'll cause any trouble. I was handed over the Wave with 97 per cent charge, with an indicated 136 km of range. While wiping it down, I admired its smooth surfaces and, on first impression, there's no mistaking it for anything other than a proper family-class scooter. My test scooter did feature a few panel gaps that other scooters didn't, so it's probably a case of early production inconsistency.

What I couldn't agree with was the plastic shroud around the TFT screen; it's just drab mass-produced plastic with no design or thought to it. I mean, it's the one thing you as a rider will look at for the longest time (other than the road, that is) and it ought to appear special, no? The alloy wheels (matte black with diamond-cut style edges) are so-so.

ON THE MOVE

To ride, you get to pick between four modes (EcoX, Eco, Ride and Sport) and set off. It's all fairly intuitive, with the throttle calibration well suited to seamless use. There is quite a bit of motor whine, though, which is an irritant at low speeds; at higher speeds, the wind noise drowns it out. In EcoX, the speedo-



WHAT'S IN STORE? The screen isn't touch-enabled. The long seat and the enormous underseat storage add to practicality. The standard 'pill' auxiliary storage adds four litres RUMAN DEVMANE

meter indicated a limit of 47 kph, which goes up to 57 kph in Eco and 75 kph in Ride. Sport lets you hit its top speed of 90 kph.

The modes are well judged, with each mode being distinctly different in performance. I feel Eco and Ride alone would have sufficed; Sport feels excessive (if fun) for a scooter of this purpose. What came in the way of my fun morning out with the Wave were the brakes, specifically the inconsistency that marked my test unit. The rear brake lever could be pulled all the way in, while the front was the opposite, being annoyingly wooden. Having adapted, braking performance itself felt good, but to expect just-right braking feel isn't a tall order in 2026, right?

What's likeable is the room on offer. The long seat is more to the benefit of the pillion (especially if there's a bulky handbag involved), although given my above-average weight I did wish for a firmer, more



contoured rider's seat. An hour of non-stop riding did create a noticeable bit of sag and, therefore, tail-bone fatigue. As an aside, I'll also add that I found the multi-function keyslot a bit unintuitive. I struggled to open the seat (that's probably on me) and couldn't once open the storage 'pill' on my own. When someone else did volunteer, I was happy to notice that it opens with a hydraulic progression rather than like a drop-down flap.

The best bit of the Wave is undoubtedly its chassis and dynamics package. Thanks to a 14/12-inch front/rear wheel combination and a visibly long wheelbase, the Wave is both flickable and remarkably stable. It's a fun scooter to ride in the city and one that didn't feel out of place on the highway either! As a result of my enthusiasm, I returned the scooter 46 km later, with 31 per cent SoC and 38 km of range left in EcoX mode. While this isn't indicative of its real-world range, I'm cer-

tain it can do far better under a more conservative riding style.

KEEP IT SIMPLE

Is it the most compelling family electric scooter out there, then? Not quite. For one, it's needlessly complex. What the Wave should have aimed for was to be the last word in real-world practicality and comfort. It isn't because Simple has evidently tried to do too many things at once (start-up syndrome, perhaps?) and so, the Wave comes across as something with a lack of clarity. Is it meant to be premium? Yes. Does it come across as such? Not consistently. Is the price tag palatable? No. What should you buy instead? There are as many answers to that as there are variants of the Wave.

Scooters, beyond the novelty-of-ownership time frame, are ridden from muscle memory. Push navigation, call and music controls (seriously?), and other connectivity bits might be the norm today, but what matters ultimately is carefree usability. I get that it matters to Simple to be impressive. With a foundationally strong scooter such as the Wave, though, it didn't have to. Isn't making an impression a bit performative anyway?

I'll admit, this isn't a problem exclusive to Simple. The EV scooter world inexplicably lives in an illusion of pretend-cool. It's a world that prominently features limited-run sneakers and sans serif fonts set against primary colours. Virality is the currency here and every new 'breakthrough' is meant to be applauded as an 'Apple moment'. Apple, however, didn't have its moment until it came up with the iPhone and the Simple Wave simply isn't one. It could've been, though. The hack is in the name itself. Should've kept it simple!

@TheMotorGram



RACE READY. The blacked-out 19-inch wheels aren't overkill. The alcantara-wrapped steering wheel feels straight out of a racecar. Fine-tuning options add to the fun! PRASHANT SHETTY

Ruman Devmane

Of late, BMW has been lenient with its 'M Division' nameplate. You'll find an M mention as easily in its entry-level SUV as you will in many of its popular EVs. This, though, is the real deal. So much that it features the letter M twice. Meet the M4 Competition M xDrive Coupe.

Under its long, swooping bonnet lies a 3.0-litre straight-six engine with BMW's TwinPower turbo trickery. That's good

enough for it to produce a heady 523 bhp made accessible via an 8-speed automatic transmission. There's four-wheel drive, too, which you can turn off for when you're feeling brave. And it's got a charmingly vocal set of exhaust pipes (four) you can prompt to sing louder at the press of a button. In BMW's sportscar spectrum, the M4 Competition sits nearly all the way at the top, second only to the M4 CS. Since pretty much all BMWs are inherently fast, there may be an overlap or two from its four-door/SUV range, but as far as two-door coupes go, the M4 Competition is

elite. It looks the part, too. I don't think my neighbours are car enthusiasts, but I saw every single one of them pose for photos with it in the time I had it on test. The Fire Orange shade certainly helped. You sit low and snug in the M4 and despite its size, it's an easy car to judge traffic in. Even puttering around gently feels special enough, given how racy the interior is, without being overdone. You hear the bassy exhaust note at all speeds and when you're finally ready to step on the throttle, you'll do yourself a favour if you slide the windows down. Oh, it sounds incredible!

You've to be mindful of the temptation to blip the throttle though, because the M4 Competition has enough firepower to go from 0-100 kph (3.5 seconds, by the way) in your driveway itself. It's also quite weight sensitive, agonisingly scraping speed breakers with two occupants, although driving solo it scraped none! Of course, given how race-ready it is, you're constantly bouncing around on anything that isn't perfect tarmac, which is the domain of the affluent few in a city like Mumbai. That said, I didn't mind being bounced around given how easy to drive and readily fun the

M4 felt just about everywhere. Those 19-inch wheels are definitely a safe bet for those of you considering the M4 Competition as a daily driver.

COMPETITION READY

What adds to the M4's usability is all the fine-tuning you can do with its setup. The engine and chassis can be set to three modes (Efficiency, Sport or Sport Plus), the steering and brakes to two (Comfort or Sport), and the M xDrive can be stepped up from 4WD to 4WD Sport or be turned off to give you rear-wheel drive. Having experienced it first hand, I coul-



dn't be more grateful for it, given the far-from-ideal conditions I happened to be driving it in.

On a good stretch of tarmac, especially around corners, the M4 wastes no time in announcing its lineage. It's fast in a most addictive way, and its roadholding manners are impeccable.

While it's stupendously agile and responsive, I did find the steering a bit too light and floaty at high speeds, which can feel hairy in a car that eats 300 kph for breakfast. The brakes, fortunately, are top notch.

To summarise, the M4 Competition M xDrive is as hardcore a

BMW as you can buy, especially if you have a thing for fewer doors. It's also surprisingly practical, given its usable boot and room for two (short) occupants in the rear seats. This or a Mercedes-AMG CLE 53 Coupe, then? While the CLE is substantially cheaper (₹1.32 crore, ex-showroom), it's also considerably less powerful (465 bhp) and lower on its torque output (57.1 kg-m vs the M4's 66.2 kg-m) as well. With no competition from Porsche either, the M4 is practically in a field of its own. You'll make do, right?

@TheMotorGram

QUICKLY.

SBICAP, Appreciate join hand for global stocks



Mumbai: SBICAP Securities Ltd has partnered with Appreciate Broking IFSC Pvt Ltd to give retail investors access to international markets through the GIFT City IFSC ecosystem, the companies announced on September 11 at the Global Fintech Fest in Mumbai. The launch was inaugurated by Challa Sreenivasulu Setty, Chairman of State Bank of India. The partnership makes SBICAP Securities one of the few platforms in India to offer access through both GIFT City-based Global Access Providers, India INX GA, a BSE subsidiary, and NSEIGXA, an NSE subsidiary, under a single platform experience. Investors will be able to trade over 8,000 US-listed stocks and global ETFs, with fractional investing starting at \$1. OUR BUREAU

Mann Fleet Partners gets SEBI nod for IPO

New Delhi: Mann Fleet Partners has secured SEBI's approval to raise funds through an initial public offering (IPO), an update with the markets regulator showed on Friday. The proposed IPO comprises a fresh issue of 60.12 lakh shares and an offer for sale of 19.1 lakh shares by promoters and individual shareholders, according to the draft red herring prospectus. The company plans to use the proceeds from the fresh issue for debt payment and general corporate purposes. Mann Fleet Partners, which filed its preliminary papers with SEBI in June, obtained its observations on September 8, the update showed. PTI

BROKER'S CALL.

JM Financial

ACUTAA'S CHEM (BUY)

Target: ₹3,800
CMP: ₹3,377.35
We expect Acutaas Chemicals to deliver sustained earnings growth driven by a strong 28 per cent CAGR in the CDMO business over FY26-30E, and incremental contribution from newer businesses such as electrolyte additives, semiconductors and electronic chemicals. Our calculations suggest Daro-volumes could grow about 3x over FY26-30E to about 160 tonne by FY30E supported by the expanding Nubega patient base following successful outcomes of ARASTEP and DASL-HiCaP trial. This is expected to translate to Daro-V revenue of about ₹1,700 crore by FY30E, which would be the key growth driver in the CDMO business. We are also building in about 45 per cent CAGR for Specialty Chemicals' revenue — increasing from ₹160 crore in FY26 to ₹730 crore by FY30E — driven by the shift towards higher value semiconductor chemicals and electrolyte additives. In Pharma Intermediates, we expect the four new CDMO molecules to scale up to ₹320 crore by FY30E while Apixaban's anticipated Nov'26 patent expiry is expected to support growth in the legacy pharma business. Overall, we reckon a revenue/EBITDA/PAT CAGR of 28/29/28 per cent over FY26-30E. This note marks resumption of coverage on Acutaas with a Buy and target price of ₹3,800 based on 45x Sep'28E EPS.

Emkay Global Fin

AAVAS FINANCIERS (ADD)

Target: ₹1,600
CMP: ₹1,275.10
We met the management of Aavas Financiers (Manu Singh - MD and CEO) to discuss its business strategy and the near-to-medium term growth outlook. Key takeaways: The management expects 16-18 per cent AUM growth in FY27 (disbursement growth of about 22-23 per cent) and around 20 per cent sustainable growth over the medium term. Housing remains a key focus area, with management aiming to maintain the HL/NHL mix at around 65:35, broadly in line with the portfolio mix. While the increased focus on housing is likely to weigh on margins, management remains focused on risk-adjusted pricing, introducing new high-yielding state-specific products, and improving income per transaction to offset the pressure. Growth will be supported by branch additions, higher employee productivity, and customer retention, with management targeting to double field productivity per employee over the next two years. Overall profitability will remain strong, supported by stringent cost controls, higher revenue per resource, and operating leverage. Overall, Aavas Financiers remains well placed to deliver sustainable growth, with stable asset quality and profitability outlook. We retain Add with Jun-27E target price of ₹1,600, implying a PBV of 1.9x. With the ongoing implementation of its strategy and processes, we believe Aavas remains on track to deliver its 16-18 per cent AUM growth guidance in FY27 and sustain mid-teens ROE, with improving employee productivity, margins and AUM growth expected to support continued execution and remain key monitorables.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

6 IPOs worth ₹4,510 cr get bids for ₹1.4 lakh crore

STREET SMART. Rentomojo, Karamtara Engineering and LCC Projects were the biggest draws, while Steamhouse India and ARCIL saw a modest response

KS Badri Narayanan
Chennai

Friday saw the initial public offerings of six companies from a wide range of sectors closed with overwhelming response from investors across classes. In fact, as against the cumulative IPO size of ₹4,510 crore, the six issues received bids worth ₹1.39 lakh crore.

Among them, the biggest draws were Rentomojo, Karamtara Engineering and LCC Projects, while Steamhouse India and Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd (Arcil) saw a modest response even as the issue of Manipl Payment and Identity Solutions sailed through.

RENTOMOJO

The ₹1,256-crore IPO of Rentomojo attracted bids for 157.49 crore shares against

2.18 crore shares on offer, which means 72.88 times subscription. The IPO of on-line furniture and appliance rental platform, which came out with a price band of ₹384-404, saw heavy attraction from qualified institutional buyers (QIBs) with subscription of 177.29 times followed by non-institutional investors or HNIs at 67.93 times and retail investors at 15.59 times. Even the employee quota saw strong bids for nearly 21.03 times.

The issue comprised a fresh issue of ₹150 crore and an offer for sale (OFS) worth ₹1,106 crore. From the fresh issue, it will allocate ₹70 crore towards repayment or prepayment of borrowings and ₹42.5 crore towards lease rentals or licence fees for warehouses and experience stores, with the rest for general corporate purposes.

Overwhelming response

	QIBs	Non-institutions	Retail	Employee Total portion	No. of times
Rentomojo	177.29	67.93	15.59	21.03	72.88
Karamtara Engineering	159.59	48.55	13.26		62.63
LCC Projects	78.69	62.99	25.56		48.51
Steamhouse India	43.91	44.30	16.90		30.49
ARCIL	52.65	15.69	3.39		20.10
Manipl Payment	1.26	1.22	2.19		1.42

Source: Exchange

Ahead of the public issue, Rentomojo raised ₹376.07 crore from anchor investors.

KARAMTARA

Karamtara Engineering's ₹875-crore IPO received bids for 158.04 crore shares against 2.54 crore shares on offer, translating into a subscription of 62.63 times. The IPO, comprising a fresh issue of ₹675 crore and an OFS of ₹200 crore, hit the market with a price band of ₹241-25.

Karamtara Engineering is a backward-integrated man-

ufacturer engaged in the business of designing and producing structural products for the renewable energy and power transmission sectors.

QIBs made aggressive bids with their reserved quota being subscribed at 159.59 times; the portion for retail investors and HNIs was subscribed 13.26 times and 48.55 times respectively.

Karamtara plans to use ₹600 crore from the fresh issue proceeds to repay borrowings.

ratio remains near historic lows, both long and short positions have been rising, suggesting FIIs are actively taking tactical positions ahead of a potentially large market move," he said.

James added that the sizeable short base could fuel a strong short-covering rally if the sentiment improves, as current positioning resembles levels seen around April, which preceded a sharp market rebound.

However, he said a sustained rally would require stronger fundamental triggers, and he did not foresee an immediate return to the record highs. "Markets typically turn bullish when the FII long-short position ratio rises above 40 per cent. With

The Mumbai-based company had raised ₹262.50 crore from anchor investors.

LCC PROJECTS

The Gujarat-based LCC Projects also saw aggressive bidding, receiving bids for 99.59 crore shares against the 2.09 crore scrips on offer (48.51 times). The ₹427-crore IPO of the EPC company came out with a price band of ₹139-146, comprising a fresh issue of ₹258 crore and OFS of ₹169.14 crore.

It raised ₹128.14 crore from anchor investors who included Astorne Capital, Edelweiss Life Insurance Company, Craft Emerging Market Fund, Sunrise Investment Trust and ASAS Global Fund.

The net proceeds from the fresh issue will be used for the purchase of equipment, repayment of certain outstanding borrowings and

general corporate purposes.

STEAMHOUSE INDIA

The ₹414-crore IPO of Steamhouse India saw healthy subscription of 30.49 times. QIBs remained the top draw at 43.91 times subscription, followed by HNIs (44.3 times) and retail (16.9 times). The IPO comprised a fresh issue of ₹353 crore and an OFS of ₹61 crore, and came out with a price band of ₹77-₹81. The net proceeds will be used for repayment of outstanding borrowings, funding capex needs for augmenting infrastructure development and general corporate purposes. The company raised ₹124.2 crore from anchor investors.

ARCIL

The IPO of ARCIL was subscribed 20.1 times, thanks to QIBs (52.65 times), HNIs (15.69 times) and retail (3.39

times). The company fixed a price band of ₹132-139 for its ₹733-crore IPO, which was entirely an OFS.

ARCIL garnered ₹220 crore from anchor investors ahead of as its three-day IPO, including Goldman Sachs India AMC, WhiteOak Capital and Bandhan MF.

MANIPAL PAYMENT

Manipl Payment's IPO was subscribed 1.42 times, thanks mainly to retail investors. The company fixed a price band of ₹322-339 for its ₹805-crore IPO.

It plans to use ₹238.4 crore for purchasing and installing new and second-hand equipment at its facilities in Manipl, Chennai, Navi Mumbai and the Chhattisgarh RTO, and for general corporate purposes.

Ahead of the IPO, Manipl Payment raised ₹362.25 crore from anchor investors.

First tokenised corporate bond launched on MSE

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Metropolitan Stock Exchange of India (MSE) has facilitated the country's first tokenised corporate bond issuance under the Securities and Exchange Board of India's (SEBI) Demat 2.0 pilot, a regulatory sandbox initiative aimed at modernising India's debt market infrastructure.

The bond was issued by IIFL Finance Ltd through MSE's Electronic Bond Platform (MSE EBP), with Trust Investment Advisors Pvt Ltd serving as the arranger.

The pilot was launched at the Global Fintech Fest 2026 in Mumbai on Friday by SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey and Reserve Bank of India Governor Sanjeev Mahotra, alongside key stakeholders from market infrastructure intermediaries, financial markets and the



Latika S Kundu, Managing Director and CEO, MSE

fintech ecosystem.

MSE Managing Director and CEO Latika S Kundu described the pilot as an important step in shaping India's debt markets, noting that tokenisation combines technology with established market infrastructure to improve efficiency and security in capital formation.

The Demat 2.0 framework signals a broader regulatory push to bring blockchain-based instruments into India's mainstream financial markets under supervised conditions.

Bosch Limited

Registered Office: Hosur Road, Adugodi, Bengaluru, Pincode - 560 030 | Tel: 92621 05931
Website: www.bosch.in; E-mail: secretarial.corp@in.bosch.com
CIN: L85110KA1951PLC000761

Important Notice to Shareholders

Special Window for Transfer and Dematerialisation (DEMAT) of Physical Shares

In furtherance to our public notice dated 13.02.26 & 15.05.2026 with respect to special window offered pursuant to SEBI Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MIRSD-POD/1/3750/2026 dated 30.01.26, we hereby reiterate that the special window for Transfer and Dematerialisation of Physical Securities will remain open up to 04.02.2027.

This facility is applicable to those investors who had purchased physical shares of Bosch Ltd ("the Company") prior to April 1, 2019 and:

- a). had not lodged the shares for transfer; or
- b). had lodged the shares for transfer, but the same were rejected, returned, or not attended to due to deficiencies in documentation.

Securities that are lodged and if found to be in order, shall be issued only in Demat Mode. Hence investors should have demat account and provide Client master List (CML) along with other documents. Due process shall be followed for such transfer request.

Investors wishing to avail of this special window may contact the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent, Integrated Registry Management Services Private Limited, Address: No. 30, Ramana Residency 4th Cross, Sampige Road, Malleswaram, Bengaluru - 560003; Email Id: irg@integratedindia.in; Telephone:080-23460815-818

Applicability of the special Window:

For clarity regarding applicability of this window to transfer the deeds executed before April 1, 2019, investors may refer to the matrix below:

Lodged for transfer before April 01, 2019 ?	Is Original share certificate Available with the investor ?	Whether eligible to lodge in the current Special Window ?
No, it is fresh lodgement	Yes	Yes (subject to conditions stated in the SEBI Circular)
Yes, but was rejected/returned earlier	Yes	
Yes was lodged	No	No
No, was not lodged	No	No

Kindly note that requests which are accompanied by original share certificates along with transfer deed(s) and other supporting documents will only be considered under the special window.

Cases not considered under this special Window

Cases involving disputes between transferor and transferee will not be considered in this window and may be settled by transferor and transferee through court/NCLT process.

Securities which have been transferred to Investor Education and Protection Fund (IEPF) shall not be considered under this window for processing.

For Bosch Limited,
Sd/-
V. Srinivasan

Place: Bengaluru Company Secretary & Compliance Officer
Date: 11.09.2026 Membership No.ACS16430

IFSCA pilots Aadhaar-based onboarding of UAE-based NRIs

Avinash Nair
Mumbai

An NRI sitting in the United Arab Emirates (UAE) on a Saturday night could soon be able to open a fund manager's app, complete Aadhaar-based face authentication and invest \$10,000 without a paper form, physical visit or assisted verification. That is the kind of seamless cross-border investing experience the International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) is now working towards as it pilots an unassisted Aadhaar face authentication system for NRIs in the UAE, in a move aimed at making GIFT City a gateway for India's vast diaspora and global investors.

IFSCA Chairman K Rajaraman said the pilot is currently being conducted in the UAE for people who have Aadhaar, primarily NRIs. The objective is to solve one of the biggest friction points in cross-border financial services, getting customers sitting overseas digitally on-boarded while meeting KYC requirements.

This initiative builds on the IFSCA's efforts to create a completely digital onboarding and documentation framework for overseas



IFSCA Chairman K Rajaraman

investors.

The IFSCA Chairman told *businessline* on Friday that the pilot is meant to test the technology in an international environment.

SECURITY TESTING

The international pilot will, therefore, examine how foreign IPs can access the Aadhaar application without compromising its security. Data generated during the exercise will be used to identify potential vulnerabilities before the system is rolled out more widely. The system is expected to be in place by the end of the current financial year, he added.

The pilot is expected to be extended to three more jurisdictions, including the US, as IFSCA tests the feasibility and security of Aadhaar-based face authentication for overseas investors.

For IFSCA, the technology

push is part of a larger strategy to turn GIFT City into a hub through which the Indian diaspora can access global investment opportunities while also investing into India. India has an estimated 36 million-strong diaspora worldwide, including about 16 million NRIs and 19 million persons of Indian origin, according to the Chairman.

IFSCA sees this community as a significant pool of potential investors, particularly high networth individuals, family offices and globally dispersed Indian-origin businesses. To tap this market, the regulator is encouraging banks operating in the International Financial Services Centre to establish wealth-management units.

"Banks such as HSBC and SBI have already set up operations, catering to HNI clients and family offices with global footprints," the IFSCA Chairman said while speaking at the Global Fintech Fest 2026 in Mumbai.

The broader opportunity, however, goes beyond bringing money into India. IFSCA wants GIFT City to become the platform through which NRIs can invest globally as well as invest in India, effectively allowing the IFSC to function as a cross-border wealth-management hub for the diaspora.

SEBI proposes extending IT, cyber security framework of MIIs to their arms

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Markets regulator SEBI on Friday proposed extending the IT and cyber security framework of market infrastructure institutions (MIIs) — comprising stock exchanges, depositories, and clearing corporations — to their subsidiaries to strengthen regulatory oversight.

While MIIs are governed by SEBI and operate in compliance with its IT and cyber-security frameworks, the applicability and regulatory jurisdiction of these frame-

work are not explicitly defined over their subsidiaries.

The move comes even as SEBI highlighted that there could be a case for MIIs to take services of their subsidiaries to carry out certain activities.

SHARED INFRA

These subsidiaries may need to operate in close coordination with the parent MII and might use shared technology infrastructure, applications, market data or other critical IT resources.

"As MIIs continue to diversify their business models through subsidiaries, extend-

ing the applicability of the framework would ensure that the regulatory framework remains aligned with the evolving market structure," SEBI said in its consultation paper.

Under the proposal, the IT and cyber security framework applicable to the parent MII will also apply to any subsidiary undertaking activity that directly contributes to that MII's domain.

In other words, the subsidiary is carrying out an activity which the MII is supposed to do, handling data that the MII is supposed to handle or sharing infrastructure with the MII.

Nifty 50 Movers					▼ 79.70 pts.
	Close(T)	Pts	FE	WN%	
HDFC Bank	708.25	48.35	13.22	10.13	
Kotak Bank	419.00	3.94	20.53	2.88	
Dr Reddys Lab	1165.50	3.00	30.56	0.66	
Eternal Ltd	223.50	2.21	72.96	2.18	
Tech Mahindra	1541.00	2.11	29.25	0.91	
IntiGlobeAvi	4973.00	1.38	0.00	1.05	
ITC	259.85	1.16	16.13	2.34	
Infosys	1037.70	0.92	13.88	3.40	
HDFC Life	530.00	0.91	57.90	0.53	
Wipro	167.40	0.65	12.46	0.42	
UltraTech Cement	11000.00	0.54	37.82	1.22	
Tata Motors PV	301.10	0.27	0.00	0.59	
Avis Bank	1246.00	0.00	13.87	3.34	
Max Healthcare	1037.70	-0.15	69.30	0.72	
HCL Tech	1206.10	-0.21	18.77	1.19	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	229.90	-0.25	73.46	0.70	
NestleIndia	1383.30	-0.45	69.99	0.93	
Bharat Elec	404.35	-0.51	48.08	1.35	
Adani Ports	1764.60	-0.55	30.99	1.22	
TCS	2200.80	-0.74	15.91	2.10	
Cipla	1366.00	-0.90	32.89	0.72	
Titan	5009.50	-1.04	77.21	1.93	
Adani Enter	3060.00	-1.08	52.99	0.92	
Trent Ltd.	2902.40	-1.19	82.35	0.87	
TataConsumerProduct	991.00	-1.22	59.72	0.60	
Apollo Hosp	8836.00	-1.44	58.49	0.85	
SBI Life	1684.70	-1.56	64.98	0.71	
NTPC	333.40	-1.66	11.41	1.48	
Bajaj Auto	11678.00	-2.18	28.25	1.21	
Asian Paints	2472.50	-2.53	49.03	1.04	
PowerGrid Corp	269.10	-2.62	15.75	1.14	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1028.60	-2.88	21.38	1.35	
Coal India	426.40	-2.93	8.43	0.95	
Hind Unilever	1927.00	-2.97	43.15	1.60	
Grosum Ind	3281.90	-3.06	19.63	1.16	
M&M	3107.00	-3.29	19.09	2.59	
Bajaj Finserv	1913.50	-3.42	14.84	1.03	
ONGC	232.50	-4.05	6.53	0.84	
Sun Pharma	1840.00	-4.86	36.43	1.82	
Eicher Motors	7530.00	-5.03	35.81	0.97	
Bharti Airtel	1831.10	-5.25	30.64	5.20	
Bajaj Finance	1034.50	-5.26	31.19	2.59	
Maruti Suzuki	12400.00	-5.42	27.20	1.51	
L&T	3930.70	-6.22	27.56	4.30	
Tata Steel	183.00	-6.83	20.28	1.41	
JSW Steel	1265.00	-7.99	11.05	1.11	
(ICI) Bank	1379.30	-8.14	16.56	9.23	
Hindalco	981.50	-10.28	13.45	1.33	
State Bank	695.70	-12.65	10.25	3.84	
Reliance Ind	1257.50	-24.36	19.30	7.93	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers					▼ 447.20 pts.
	Close(T)	Pts	FE	WN%	
Varun Beverages .	416.50	23.84	41.32	2.30	
Bajaj Holdings	11314.00	17.87	13.78	1.94	
Saimwardmotherinternat	164.45	16.05	38.10	2.93	
Torrent Pharma	4965.50	15.13	87.60	2.94	
Bpcl	394.50	8.83	7.71	2.49	
India Hotels Co .	718.50	7.02	44.30	2.54	
Bank Of Baroda	238.13	2.75	6.70	1.78	
Power Finance	353.45	2.75	3.47	2.07	
Tvs Motor Cmp .	4125.00	2.39	54.42	3.91	
Indian Oilcorp	956.45	1.85	5.34	2.04	
Zyduslifestyles	1119.10	0.95	24.52	1.13	
Siemens	3957.00	0.67	97.00	1.41	
Siemens Energy India .	3181.30	0.57	76.14	1.13	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	81.09	0.06	14.74	0.66	
Tata Capital	362.90	-0.37	28.12	0.74	
Avenuesuper	3688.00	-0.94	78.67	2.40	
Punjab Natl Bank	116.75	-1.00	6.06	1.62	
Pitdlind	1566.90	-1.89	59.59	1.96	
Udaan	312.70	-3.99	5.14	1.57	
United Spirits.	139.05	-4.29	60.15	1.65	
Solar Industries	22290.00	-5.66	98.37	2.19	
Goodfry Consumer	865.00	-5.72	46.25	1.40	
Canara Bank	124.00	-5.86	5.67	1.68	
Union Bank	178.10	-6.18	6.59	1.38	
Ambuja Cements	391.85	-6.79	18.77	0.98	
Gail (India)	173.62	-6.82	11.57	1.89	
24x7 Supermart	225.00	-6.86	4.99	1.12	
Abb India	727.40	-8.39	99.12	1.54	
Mazdaagon Dock	233.00	-9.76	33.06	0.72	
Bosch	48385.00	-9.83	60.39	1.69	
Power & Ind Sol	909.00	-11.06	115.63	2.51	
Tata Power	364.65	-11.39	92.78	1.25	
Hyundai Motor India .	2174.00	-12.85	35.68	1.45	
Britannia Ind	2792.10	-15.40	9.17	2.48	
Britannia Ind	4962.00	-16.09	45.79	2.98	
CholamandalamFinKfnc	184.95	-16.47	27.36	3.22	
AdaniGreenenergy	1281.30	-17.34	98.35	1.73	
Hdfc Amc	240.91	-17.72	34.96	1.98	
Indial Steel	1120.50	-17.76	42.20	1.67	
Adani Energy Solutions .	133.70	-18.04	53.37	1.82	
HDFC	694.50	-21.16	35.88	1.67	
Industrialelectrica	576.45	-23.97	14.37	1.21	
Industrialeaeronautics	400.00	-24.81	35.19	3.75	
Vedanta	263.70	-26.36	6.18	1.80	
Timindtree	4275.00	-26.72	24.40	1.60	
Tata Motors Cv	434.55	-28.53	38.22	3.66	
Cummins India	5070.00	-33.37	59.37	2.76	
Macrotech Developers .	1116.90	-37.49	27.03	1.25	
Power .	269.87	-37.57	27.86	3.51	
Divis Lab	932.00	-43.03	84.61	4.78	
Pts: Impact on index movement					

Risky bets

There must be checks on mutual funds investing in IPOs

There has been frenzied activity in the primary market for equities in the last three years — with promoters making the most of growing demand to raise capital at extremely high valuations, and investors buying these issuances to rake in quick gains. What is concerning here is that mutual funds have been participating aggressively in the primary market in recent years.



A recent analysis by this newspaper shows that mutual fund investments accounted for around one-third of the aggregate size of the mainboard IPOs in 2024 and 2025 and 26.6 per cent of the IPOs which opened between January and August 2026. Investments in the primary market are riskier than in the secondary market due to the sheer lack of information on companies making primary offers. Information about an IPO-bound company is largely limited to its offer documents. In the case of a listed stock, there would be sufficient historical record of financial and operational performance as well as management conduct to help investors take an informed decision. With primary issues, the risk has been compounded by price manipulation in many stocks in the period immediately following the listing to enable subscribers to exit early with hefty gains. But given the pressure on mutual funds to deploy high inflows through systematic investment plans, they appear keen to invest in IPOs — often without due diligence. This could hurt investor interests.

Mutual funds invested in over 90 per cent of the IPOs between 2020 and 2022 and around 78 per cent of those over the last four years. The amount of investor funds invested in primary market has been increasing steadily; rising from ₹6,684 crore in 2020 to ₹57,668 crore in 2025. SEBI's rules have been largely supportive of mutual fund money flowing into the primary market. The regulator allows them to invest through the qualified institutional buyer category or as anchor investors, one day prior to the opening of the IPO. Given the confirmed allocation in the anchor investor portion, mutual funds have been leaning on this route to buy IPO stocks.

But many fund managers appear to be viewing primary market investment as a short-term opportunity. According to a recent SEBI survey, MFs had exited 38 per cent of the anchor allotment by the end of one year from allotment. SEBI must review the rules governing mutual funds' investment in primary offerings. Last year, the regulator had barred mutual funds from participating in pre-IPO placements since that could saddle them with illiquid securities, if the offer is delayed. Rules can be carved out for MF schemes which are eligible to invest in IPOs. Special primary market funds can be introduced as a category, where IPO stocks can be parked. That will also give investors the option of choosing to invest in IPO offerings. If regular equity or hybrid schemes invest in primary offerings, the value of these investments should be limited to less than 5 per cent of the portfolio value.

OTHER VOICES.

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

Trump Eyes Pickaxe Mountain, Again
‘We noticed there’s a little activity at Pickaxe,’ President Trump said Wednesday night at the GOP midterm convention, and we’re glad he’s watching the Iranian nuclear site. ‘I would advise Iran not to get cute,’ Mr. Trump continued, ‘because we will have to hit them very hard.’ Buried 330-475 feet beneath a mountain, the unfinished site appears designed to hold a nuclear enrichment facility too deep for U.S. bunker-busters to hit. Satellite imagery reviewed by the Center for Strategic and International Studies indicates “a clear surge in construction activity in 2026” and a shift “from active excavation toward probable internal construction.” NEW YORK, SEPTEMBER 10

CHINADAILY

No surrender, no swagger, Canada fights back
Canada’s trade war with the United States has entered a new phase. Ottawa’s latest counter-tariffs, covering C\$27.6 billion (\$20 billion) of US goods, took effect this week after talks collapsed. The US administration has threatened more measures, including restrictions on Canadian goods and services. The US president has also revived his idea of making Canada the US’ 51st state, called its prime minister a “governor” and even renamed Lake Ontario “Lake America”. Tariffs are one thing. Telling a sovereign neighbor that it would be better off without sovereignty is another. Canada is justified in pushing back. Its tariffs are less an exercise in economic defense than an attempt to establish a simple principle: interdependence is not submission. Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney has argued that Canada cannot be expected to admit US goods tariff-free while Canadian companies face barriers in the other direction. BEIJING, SEPTEMBER 10

Climate: Time for BRICS to act

GREEN AGENDA. BRICS must stop relying on the Global North for technology or finance on the climate front



ABINASH MOHANTY
ASHWAJIT SINGH

Let’s begin with a number that should end the debate before it starts: \$170 billion. That is the annual climate finance gap developing countries face, the difference between what they need to adapt to a crisis they did not create, and what the Global North has actually delivered.

At COP29, the much-celebrated climate finance deal committed \$300 billion annually by 2035, a figure that the very nations it was meant to serve called “disappointingly low” and “an insult”. India’s chief negotiator walked out. The Global South’s patience, already wearing dangerously thin, is now effectively exhausted.

Into this vacuum steps the most consequential geopolitical bloc the climate world has yet to fully reckon with: BRICS.

BRICS is no longer the acronym of a Goldman Sachs investment thesis. It is a 45-member-strong economic coalition — following the 2024 expansion; representing over 40 per cent of global GDP, more than 50 per cent of the world’s population, and crucially, the majority of the world’s most climate-exposed communities.

Brazil’s Amazon is the planet’s most critical carbon sink. Russia’s permafrost holds one of its largest methane time bombs. India has crossed 52 per cent non-fossil electricity capacity and is racing towards 500 gigawatts of renewables.

China is manufacturing 80 per cent of the world’s solar panels. South Africa sits at the heart of the continent that is losing the most while contributing the least to the crisis. This is not a bloc on the periphery of the climate conversation. It is the conversation.

And yet BRICS has spent the better part of the last decade deferring to a Global North climate architecture that has consistently failed it — promising technology transfer while patenting it, pledging climate finance while disbursing a fraction of it, and designing adaptation frameworks in Geneva for communities whose names they cannot pronounce.



POLITICAL WILL. BRICS is well placed to create the architecture for climate action @MEAINDIA

The recent catastrophic floods in Nepal — submerging entire valleys, displacing hundreds of thousands, and wiping out decades of development gains in 72 hours — are a case study in precisely what happens when the world’s most vulnerable communities are left waiting for a multilateral system that moves at the speed of diplomatic courtesy.

Technologies like that of Climate Risk Observatory — has been generating district and ward-level compound climate risk intelligence for cities across South Asia, including flood, heat, and landslide compound hazard mapping. The technology exists. The methodology exists. The need is screaming. What is missing is the political architecture to deploy it at speed and at scale — and BRICS is uniquely positioned to build that architecture.

Consider what a genuine BRICS Climate Hub would actually look like in practice. The New Development Bank, BRICS’s own multilateral financial institution, already has climate infrastructure lending in its mandate.

The Global South needs a Climate Readiness Facility, which will be a fast-disbursing, directly accessible climate finance instrument

What it needs is a Climate Readiness Facility that replicates, for the Global South, what the Green Climate Fund was always supposed to be but never quite became: a fast-disbursing, directly accessible, nationally embedded climate finance instrument that does not require a developing country to spend three years navigating accreditation bureaucracy before its most vulnerable citizens receive a single rupee or rand or real of adaptation support.

TECH TRANSFER

The technology transfer question is where the Global North’s credibility collapses most visibly. For 30 years, developed countries have promised to share the clean technologies that make the low-carbon transition possible — and for 30 years, intellectual property regimes have ensured that promise was structurally unfulfillable.

BRICS can break this cycle not by negotiating with the Global North for permission, but by building its own technology commons. China’s solar manufacturing cost curve — which has driven the price of photovoltaic panels down by 90 per cent since 2010 — is the single most important climate technology contribution of the 21st century, and it happened entirely outside the Global North’s technology transfer framework.

India’s green hydrogen mission, Brazil’s sustainable aviation fuel programme, and South Africa’s just

Adapting cooling policy to India’s AI ambitions

The heat generated by data centres require energy and water for cooling. The India Cooling Action Plan becomes crucial

Abhinav Banka
Surjith Karthikeyan

India is leaping forward as a major hub for artificial intelligence (AI) and digital infrastructure. IndiaAI Mission coupled with global technology firms’ investments are facilitating expansion of hyperscale data centres which promises significant economic and technological benefits.

However, it raises a parallel policy challenge: cooling. These data centres generate enormous amounts of heat due to the computational intensity of modern AI chips, making cooling systems a major driver of electricity consumption. As India expands its AI infrastructure, the country’s cooling policy, particularly the India Cooling Action Plan (ICAP) must link up cooling requirements of AI.

The total data centre capacity in the country is expected to reach more than 12 GW by 2030 from around 1.5 GW in 2025, and thereby occupying roughly 26.3 GW of electricity consumption by 2031-32 (about 6.7 per cent of India’s projected total electricity consumption).

Beyond electricity consumption, AI infrastructure has substantial cooling requirements, which represent one of the largest energy costs for data centres

globally, often accounting for 30-50 per cent of total energy consumption.

The industry is adopting advanced cooling technologies such as direct-to-chip liquid cooling, adiabatic cooling and immersion cooling to minimise water usage, however usage of fresh water for cooling is there to stay.

INDIA COOLING ACTION PLAN

India’s Cooling Action Plan introduced in 2019 provided a 20-year roadmap for sustainable cooling across sectors including buildings, cold chains, refrigeration, and transport. It sets ambitious targets to reduce cooling demand by 20-25 per cent and cooling energy requirements by 25-40 per cent by 2037-38 through improved energy efficiency, better refrigerants, and technological innovation.

When ICAP was formulated, hyperscale AI infrastructure had not yet become a central component of the digital economy. As a result, AI was not part of ICAP framework and it remained focused on conventional cooling applications — such as air conditioning in buildings and refrigeration in supply chains. But now data centres are knocking hard and fast on the door to get a representation in cooling action plans.

At the recent India AI Impact Summit 2026 Policymakers highlighted the need for AI development to align with broader



DATA CENTRES. Cooling implications GETTY IMAGES

climate goals under a framework anchored in “People, Planet, and Progress.”

The environmental implications of AI infrastructure extend beyond electricity consumption. Many cooling systems rely heavily on water for heat dissipation, raising concerns in regions already facing water stress. As India’s data-centre sector expands, the energy-water nexus associated with cooling will become an increasingly important policy issue.

The principles embedded in ICAP provide a useful starting point for addressing the cooling needs of AI infrastructure. The plan promotes energy-efficient cooling technologies, improved building design, and environmentally sustainable refrigerants. These principles can be extended to data-centre operations

transition partnership are all examples of the Global South generating climate solutions at scale. What they need is the institutional architecture to share them with each other — and with Nepal, with Mozambique, with Vietnam — at the speed the climate emergency demands.

GREEN JOBS POTENTIAL

The green jobs opportunity is where the BRICS Climate Hub argument becomes not just morally compelling but economically irresistible. India alone has the potential to generate 35 million green jobs by 2047.

Brazil’s bioeconomy could employ 20 million in sustainable agriculture, forest restoration, and green manufacturing by 2035. A coordinated BRICS green jobs compact — linking skills recognition, labour mobility, and green manufacturing investment across member states — would be the largest deliberate employment programme in human history. This is the growth agenda the Global South has been waiting for someone to articulate loudly enough.

For over a decade, Indian climate-focused organisations have worked at the intersection of climate science, institutional governance, and development finance across South Asia and Africa. From pioneering tools such as the Climate Readiness Index and the Mumbai Multi-Hazard Risk Atlas to supporting India’s first Model Heat Action Plan, this journey has been anchored in a fundamental conviction: the Global South must build and own the knowledge, institutions, and financing solutions needed to shape its climate-resilient future — on its own terms, responsive to its realities, and at the pace its people need. Neither can BRICS. The moment is here. The bloc is assembled. The crisis is accelerating. BRICS does not need to become the world’s climate leader by displacing anyone.

It needs to stop stepping aside for institutions that have repeatedly proven they are not equal to the scale of what this moment demands — and start building the architecture, the finance, the technology commons, and the political will to lead from where the crisis is actually being felt.

BRICS: stop waiting. Start building.

Mohanty is Director and Global Sector Head of Climate Change and Sustainability; Singh is Founder and Managing Director, IPE Global

On businessline.in

BRICS summit: The tough tightrope walk for India



https://tinyurl.com/bdfkzrap

With two BRICS members embroiled in wars, India’s diplomatic skills will be severely tested, as it cannot afford to irk Washington, says **Amitabh Ranjan**

GDP growth: Beyond the headline

The revised series may well give a more current picture of an economy where the structure, prices and sources of value addition have changed considerably, **Rahul Ranjan, Manoj Kumar and Anup Kumar Mishra** point out



https://tinyurl.com/43na37ux



QUICKLY.

Wizz Financial launches UPI cross-border app



Mumbai: Wizz Financial on Friday unveiled a multi-service financial app, positioning itself as a unified platform for cross-border payments to more than 80 countries. The app consolidates services including inward and outward remittances, multi-currency prepaid cards, UPI access for international users, lending, bill payments and travel services. *OUR BUREAU*

Borderless expands services to Africa

Mumbai: Wealthtech platform Borderless (formerly Stockal) has announced expansion into Africa. Starting with markets such as Nigeria, Ghana and Kenya, Borderless aims to ease people's access to global markets, help make investments, and move money seamlessly. *OUR BUREAU*

Zeta, Pluxee aim to end SMS OTP authentication

Mumbai: Zeta and Pluxee have gone live with passkey-based authentication for RuPay prepaid card transactions, replacing SMS OTPs with device-bound cryptographic credentials for online payments. Cardholders register a passkey once at checkout, and subsequently authenticate using biometrics. Zeta says passkey authentication completes in 5-7 seconds, compared with 15-25 seconds for OTP flows. *OUR BUREAU*

AI, the 3rd biggest shift in BFSI: Sarvam

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Sarvam AI is setting up an intelligent modular stack to streamline the overload of AI offerings for banks, the company announced at the Global Fintech Fest 2026.

Stating that AI is the third biggest shift for the BFSI sector, Vedant Trivedi, Head of Applied AI at Sarvam, said the country is still in its first year when it comes to the AI revolution.

Yet, the sector is overwhelmed with hundreds of offerings such as voice bots, document AIs, co-pilot licenses, resulting in scattered pilots, creating vendor lock-in, fragmented data, and compliance paralysis.

THE LAYERS

To address this, Sarvam talked of a “core intelligence

Toll plazas to go barrier-free soon

IN EXPRESS LANE. Highways to turn tech-savvy; new system to bring in ₹10,000 cr revenue a year: Nitin Gadkari

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

After making toll plazas cash-free, the government is working on making the tolling process fully digital and barrier-free. Expected to be rolled out by March, the new system will allow motorists to pass through toll points without stopping to pay the fees.

The system will combine vehicle number-plate recognition with Fastag for toll collection, said Nitin Gakari, Minister for Road Transport and Highways.

With AI and free-flow tolling, India will move from stopping at toll plazas to simply passing through them as the highway of tomorrow will be more intelligent,



INTELLIGENT HIGHWAY. Minister of Road Transport and Highways Nitin Gadkari addressing a session at the Global Fintech Festival 2026 in Mumbai on Friday *ANI*

seamless and cashless, he said at the Global Fintech Fest in Mumbai on Friday.

TOLL REVENUES

The next phase will be to eliminate the remaining

delays while also boosting toll collection, Gadkari said.

India's shift to electronic tolling through Fastag has delivered visible results since its launch in 2016. Fastag was made mandatory

in 2021, accelerating the shift from cash-based payments to electronic toll collection across the national highway network.

Gadkari said the new system could generate a significant increase in toll collections. “The tolling systems that we will implement, where the number plate and Fastag both will be used, will lead to an incremental increase of ₹10,000 crore in toll revenues annually,” he said.

SAVED TIME

The government is also pursuing technology-led tolling solutions as it seeks to improve collection efficiency and reduce leakages across the national highway network. It is now looking to combine Fastag data with

automatic number-plate recognition to strengthen the identification and tracking of vehicles on tolled stretches.

“The combined system is expected to add an incremental ₹10,000 crore to toll revenues annually,” Gadkari said. He added that Fastag-enabled tolling had saved the country an estimated 71 crore hours annually, translating into an economic value of roughly ₹68,500 crore a year.

He called for Fastag, UPI and Aadhaar-linked mobility data to be brought together into a single connected ecosystem, describing the ambition as moving from digital payments to intelligent mobility. He also flagged road safety as a priority, citing the high annual toll of road accidents in the country.

Biotech is a 50-year journey, not a 5-year plan: Suchitra Ella



(From left) Suresh Nambath, Editor, *The Hindu*; N Ram, Director, The Hindu Group; GV Selvam, Vice-President, Vellore Institute of Technology; Suchitra Ella, Co-Founder and MD, Bharat Biotech; G Viswanathan, Founder and Chancellor, VIT; and LV Navaneeth, CEO, The Hindu Group, at the Biotech Conclave 2026 *BUJO GHOSH*

Our Bureau
Chennai

The field of biotechnology is a marathon and cannot be approached as a short-term project, Suchitra Ella, Co-Founder and Managing Director, Bharat Biotech, and CII President-designate, said here on Friday.

Ella cautioned students against viewing education as a four-year programme followed immediately by a job. “Biotechnology is not a five-year plan, it's probably a 50-year plan,” she said, pointing to Bharat Biotech's own 30-year journey.

She was speaking at the Biotech Conclave 2026, organised by VIT Chennai in association with *The Hindu*, held in Chennai. Themed “Exploring New Frontiers in Science”, the conclave focuses on biomedical research, drug discovery, healthcare technologies, biotechnology innovation, and translating scientific research into applications.

‘GAME CHANGER’

Ella cited the example of Bharat Biotech's rotavirus vaccine, that demonstrated the values of playing the long game. It took about 15 years to develop and involved collaboration with institutions in India and the US, she said. Clinical trials involved around 8,000 babies, she added.

On AI, the life-sciences entrepreneur said it can accelerate research, but cannot replace rigorous biological testing involving humans and simulations.

“It is a game changer” and can help condense data, timelines and draw inferences, she added.

Referring to Bharat Biotech's crownjewel Covaxin, she said the pandemic vaccine programme involved 27,000 volunteers across 26-27 medical colleges and generated multiple publications in international peer-reviewed journals.

“The conviction, the cour-

● BRIDGING GAP

VIT's Viswanathan called for greater focus on education, research and researchers in India, citing the wide gap between India and the US and China when it comes to publications and patents

age and the commitment that we bring to a project is what will take us through,” she said.

NEED FOR R&D

Noting a need for India to move from being a consumer to a creator of technology, Ella said Bharat Biotech invests 15-20 per cent of its revenue in research and welcomed the government's ₹1 lakh crore RDI fund for future biotech innovations.

She also spent time interacting directly with students and answering varied queries from them. She urged biotech students to step outside campuses and out of their own comfort zones to gain varied exposure from seniors and peers so as to prepare for the rapidly evolving life-sciences sector.

The inaugural session was presided over by G Viswanathan, Founder and Chancellor, Vellore Institute of Technology. The session was attended by N Ram, Director, The Hindu Group; LV Navaneeth, CEO, The Hindu Group; Suresh Nambath, Editor, *The Hindu*, and GV Selvam, Vice-President, VIT.

Viswanathan called for greater focus on education, research and researchers in India, citing the wide gap between India and the US and China when it comes to publications and patents.

Ram highlighted Viswanathan's contributions to education and scientific institution-building, and lauded the significant role played by Bharat Biotech in India's public health and life sciences sector.



We have taken inspiration from the core banking system.

VEDANT TRIVEDI
Head of Applied AI, Sarvam

factory,” a modular stack separating fast-moving, commoditised layers from the ones crucial for institutions to retain control and IP like governance, context engineering, orchestration, and learning loops.

“We have taken inspiration from the core banking system built over the last two, three decades. They have the strategic autonomy to plug and play different layers of the stack as they wish and move at the pace of frontier,” said Trivedi.

The bottom layer relates

to infrastructure, which Sarvam advises sourcing from a secure, centralised “token factory” inside the country, considering the growth in chipset development and other hardware.

MOVING IN STEP

The models layer, helps institutions keep from committing to a single provider. The governance layer deals with model risk management and a centralised “kill switch” to enforce policy compliance across AI agents at runtime. The context engine layer determines how a bank's data is pre-packaged and represented to agents for accuracy and cost-efficiency.

The final orchestration layer improves performance.

This can help banks move technologies in step with AI innovation without being tied down to a single hyperscaler.



Fraud must be treated as an ecosystem problem, requiring cooperation across banks, payment system operators, fintechs, telcos and law enforcement

SHIRISH CHANDRA MURMU
Deputy Governor, RBI

risk, in which vulnerabilities in one participant can affect many others. The exclusive “bank.in” domain for banks is one measure intended to strengthen this foundation.



“Speed reduces the time available to detect and reverse fraud or error. Customer awareness, effective grievance redressal, transaction monitoring and appro-

Jan Dhan customers moving into mainstream banking: SBI

Avinash Nair
Mumbai

The Jan Dhan story is entering its next phase. State Bank of India (SBI), which holds nearly 30 per cent of the Jan Dhan accounts, says the average balance in them has risen to around ₹5,000 from the zero-balance starting point as millions of first-time customers move beyond basic access to savings, insurance and pensions.

The shift comes against the backdrop of the number of Jan Dhan accounts reaching 590 million, with a chunk of them coming from tier 3 and tier 4 areas, said Rama Mohan Rao Amara, MD (RB&O), SBI. More than half of these accounts are held by

● STEADY RISE

The average balance in PMJDY accounts has risen to around ₹5,000 from the zero-balance starting point, says Rama Mohan Rao Amara, MD (RB&O), SBI

women. “Time and again, we talk about the transformational impact of the PMJDY, Aadhaar, mobile, coupled with various fintech applications [and] the kind of transformation they have brought to the economy,” he said.

FINANCIAL INCLUSION

The change, he said, is not only about opening bank ac-

counts but also overcoming the access and gender biases associated with financial inclusion. SBI is now seeking to graduate these customers from savings to financial protection. The bank is encouraging customers to take the next step by adopting insurance products such as the Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana and Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana, while also promoting products such as the Atal Pension Yojana.

The next challenge, though, may be one of trust rather than access. “If we do not have a robust mechanism to address grievances in a timely manner, then it is only a question of time before people lose faith in it,” he said.

Razorpay, EbixCash, 13 others line up for GIFT City licences

Avinash Nair
Mumbai

Razorpay IFSC, Regulus Pay IFSC and EbixCash World Money Global IFSC are among the 10-15 payment-service providers who are at an advanced stage of setting up operations in GIFT City.

The regulator has so far authorised nine payment-service providers, while another 10-15 are at an advanced stage of obtaining licences in GIFT City, said IFSCA Executive Director Dipesh Shah. Regulus Pay IFSC applied to the IFSCA in August while Razorpay IFSC and EbixCash World Money Global IFSC submitted their applications in July.

ONE-STOP SOLUTION

The growing interest, said Shah, was partly driven by GIFT City's unified regulatory architecture, which allows payment companies to serve multiple financial-services businesses without having to navigate separate regulators.

GIFT City, he said, solves this problem by bringing banking, insurance, capital markets and several other



financial-services segments under one regulator. “As a PSP, you can cater to all of them,” Shah said at the Global Fintech Fest in Mumbai on Friday.

Under the IFSC framework, PSPs can undertake a range of activities including account services, e-money services, cross-border money transfers, merchant acquisition and escrow services.

The relatively low capital requirement compared with India's onshore regime is also helping make GIFT City attractive to payment companies, Shah said. Payment companies can also use the IFSC as a launchpad for global expansion while also facilitating outward flows from India under the Liberalised Remittance Scheme.

‘Better access to credit, gaining consumer trust will matter most’

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

India's next digital decade will be less about making transactions and services faster and more about using digital intelligence to improve access to credit, personalise consumer experiences and build trust.

Sajith Sivanandan, CEO and MD, Tata Digital, said the evolution of quick commerce showed how consumer expectations changed dramatically. He also cautioned against assuming that rapid delivery would remain the benchmark. “Pricing, convenience, speed and quality” will matter, but the model will have to evolve as companies expand beyond metros, he added.

Ashwini Kumar Tewari, MD (CB&S), SBI, said UPI transaction data could help lenders understand cash flows and sales behaviour of small businesses. The Account Aggregator framework and the Unified Lending Interface may also help lenders process business loans faster, he said.

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[C] LINE: E-492, 505, 508, 509, 510, 511, 512, 513/ TL/ UG/ 66/ 132/ 220KV/ S&L, E: - (1) LILO of existing 220 kV D/C Amreli - Visavadar line at prop. 220 kV Vaghaniya (Bagasara) S/s., (2) 220 kV 1C x 1200 sq. mm Al. Cond. XLPE U/G Cable (2(6+0)) Prop. 220 kV M/C Cable Term. Tower AP-4 to 220 kV Kanbha GIS and from AP-37 to 220 kV Dehgam S/s., (3) 132 kV 2 x (3+0) 1Cx800 sq.mm U/G cable for of 2nd circuit of 132 kV D/C Varshamed - Wankaner line at 132 kV Mota Dahisara S/s., (4) 220 kV 1Cx1200 sq.mm, 2x (3+0) copper cond. XLPE U/G cable laying LILO from Prop.220 kV M/C cable term. tower to 220 kV Kanbha GIS from Existing Ranasan Karamsad S/C line with Deer Cond., (5) 132 kV 2x (3+0) 1Cx800 sq.mm U/G cable laying 132 kV LILO Chiloda from 132 kV Ranasan Vijapur line. (From prop. AP 5/0(DD+3) cable term. tower to 132 kV Chiloda S/s under KSY-II., (6) 66 kV 1Cx630 sq.mm XLPE cable with Poly AL-Poly / Al. Corr. const. on EPC basis for various lines in Amreli Circle Package-1, Gondal Circle Package-2 and Junagadh Circle Package-3 in Rajkot Zone., (7) 66 kV, 1CX630 sq.mm XLPE Cable with Poly.AI./ Al. Corr. const. on EPC basis Various lines under Navsari Circle., (8) 66 kV, 1CX630 sq.mm XLPE Cable with Poly.AI. /Al. Corr. const. on EPC basis various lines under Bharuch Circle.
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QUICKLY.

Gold climbs on dip buying, Fed hike bets rise



Gold prices firmed over one per cent on Friday, rebounding from recent losses and finding a short-term floor despite strong US inflation data lifting expectations of a Federal Reserve rate hike next week. Spot gold rose 1.6 per cent to \$4,385.14 per ounce by 1323 GMT. US gold futures gained 0.5 per cent to \$4,426.90. Silver rose 2.1 per cent to \$64.86. REUTERS

Copper on track for first weekly dip since June

Copper prices were headed for their first weekly drop since June on a *Reuters* report that the US had not made a decision on imposing a tariff on the metal. Three-month copper on the LME was down 0.1 per cent at \$14,221 a tonne as of 0930 GMT. Aluminium fell 0.8 per cent to \$3,265.50. Nickel and tin both shed 1.1 per cent to \$16,475 and \$53,675, respectively. REUTERS

Crude oil set for weekly gain on supply disruptions



Crude oil prices slipped but were still up more than seven per cent for the week as attacks along key shipping routes stoked prolonged supply disruption fears. Brent crude futures were down \$3.75 to \$103.88 a barrel at 1012 GMT. US West Texas Intermediate crude fell \$3.33 to \$99.15. Both benchmarks hit their highest levels since mid May earlier in the session. REUTERS

‘Shift from rain-fed farming has led to fall in pulses, oilseeds and millets output’

CHOUHAN SPEAKS. Irrigation has led to paddy-wheat rotation, but farmers’ income is important, says Agri Minister

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan said that while he ensured irrigation in more land as the Chief Minister of Madhya Pradesh, it also resulted in the diversification from millets and pulses crops to paddy-wheat rotation. But he underscored the importance of raising farmers’ incomes, in which irrigation played a major role. Addressing the three-day Dryland Congress, organised by the ICAR and Icrisat, which commenced in New Delhi on Thursday, Chouhan responded to a comment from ML Jat, Director-General of the Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR), praising the Minister’s efforts in completely

transforming Madhya Pradesh in agriculture. “What did we change? We arranged water, built dams, constructed canals and water arrived. But as soon as water arrived, our millets disappeared, our pulses disappeared and our oilseeds disappeared. We used to grow such wonderful [green] peas here! Now, only two crops are being grown — paddy, followed by wheat, and if water is available, then green gram (summer moong) as the third,” he said.

DIVERISIFICATION FOCUS
He said earlier there was crop diversification, and agriculture was rain-fed. “Even in our fields, we never grew wheat and paddy alone. Chickpeas, lentils, green pea, linseed, sesame, green gram, black gram...

“
We have three major goals: Ensuring food and nutrition security and higher income to farmers
SHIVRAJ SINGH CHOUHAN
Agriculture Minister



rain-fed agriculture is where pulses, oilseeds and millets thrive. Nearly 85-87 per cent of the country’s millets — whether nutritious grains, pulses or oilseeds — are grown in these regions, and livestock also survives in these areas. **MAJOR GOALS**
As soon as water and other resources arrived, everything else faced cuts.

Hyderabad to be Asia’s hub for gene-editing: Corteva’s Vylor

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Vylor Inc, the new entity of the US-based Corteva Agriscience after the separation of its seed and agrochemical business, plans to develop its Hyderabad research centre as a gene-editing hub for Asia. Vylor is preparing to list on the New York Stock Exchange separately on October 1. In a media round table in New Delhi on Friday, Robert Kaan, Head of APAC and Strategic Growth Initiatives at Corteva’s seed business, said: “After the separation, Vylor intends to maintain the \$1 billion annual R&D budget, while Corteva will make independent decisions on spending in R&D on crop protection.”

The daily spending currently amounts to \$2.8 million, devoted to seed R&D, he said, adding that the investment could increase as the company grows. Globally, Corteva spends \$1.4 billion a year on research and development (R&D), about \$1 billion on seed research and about \$400 million on crop protection. In India, Corteva’s seeds are sold under the Pioneer brand, and due to its popularity among farmers, Vylor will continue to sell its products under ‘Pioneer’ in India.

CENTRE’S CAPABILITIES
Vylor operates a Multi-Crop Research Centre in Hyderabad, with the most advanced R&D facilities outside the US, the company spokesperson said.

The centre has capabilities in breeding, DNA analysis, haploid technology and related advanced tools, he said. Post-split, the company sees Hyderabad not just as a research and manufacturing base, but as a potential technology hub for other countries, especially in areas like gene editing, Kaan said. India will remain a key manufacturing, research and export hub for the seeds business, with some exports to neighbouring countries. On India’s delay in releasing the world’s first gene-edited rice varieties for commercial cultivation, he said the company is highly hopeful as the technology could provide the necessary solution for raising yields. “We hope India develops a fast, predictable and streamlined regulatory system,” he said.

Groundnut, sesame seeds top oilseed exports

Our Bureau
Mangaluru



The Solvent Extractors’ Association of India (SEA) has said that the export pattern of oilseeds for the first quarter of 2026-27 shows a strong concentration around value-added groundnut kernels and sesame seeds. BV Mehta, Executive Director of the SEA, said groundnut exports, particularly shelled kernels, continue to form the backbone of India’s oilseed export trade, while sesame makes a significant contribution to export earnings. Referring to the latest DGFT data, he said India exported 2.09 lakh tonnes (lt) of oilseeds, valued at ₹2,618 crore, during April-June 2026-27. **VITAL OPPORTUNITY**
Groundnut and sesame together accounted for the overwhelming share of exports, both in terms of

volume and value. Stating that groundnut remains India’s most important oilseed export opportunity, he said shelled groundnut alone accounted for 1.33 lt, valued at ₹1,550 crore, during the first quarter of 2026-27. India exported around 6.63 lt of groundnut, valued at ₹6,092 crore, during fiscal 2025-26. The country exported 61,248 tonnes of sesame valued at ₹945 crore during April-June 2026-27. It imported 5.8 lt of oilseeds, mainly soybean and sesame seed, valued at ₹3,146 crore, during the first quarter of 2026-27.

Pepper prices firm up on festival demand, lower domestic output

V Sajeev Kumar
Kochi

Lanka has resulted in a higher volume of shipments arriving in India.



Increasing demand ahead of the festival season has pushed up black pepper prices, prompting stakeholders to depend more on imports to meet demand. Prices of imported pepper, particularly from Sri Lanka, have increased due to currency fluctuations in the Lankan rupee amid increased buying interest. According to traders, domestic pepper prices are holding at elevated levels of around ₹704 a kg for ungarbled varieties and ₹724 for garbled varieties. About 50 tonnes of pepper arrived on Thursday, with the majority sourced from Sri Lanka. Higher production in Sri

ADVERSE WEATHER
Kishore Shamji, Director of the Indian Pepper and Spice Trade Association (IPSTA), said adverse climatic conditions in several major growing regions, including Tamil Nadu, Karnataka and Idukki in Keralam, had hit production due to insufficient rainfall. Although India’s pepper production for the 2026 harvest season is estimated at 65,000-75,000 tonnes, reports suggest actual production could be considerably lower due to the impact of El Nino, he said. Festival demand, beginning with Ganesh Chaturthi and extending through Navratri and Deepavali, is pick-

ing up in several upcountry markets. The increase in consumption, coupled with changing food habits, is supporting demand for pepper. **VIETNAM, BRAZIL**
To meet the rising demand, the industry is increasingly looking at imports, Shamji said.

Sri Lanka had emerged as the preferred source for imports due to its bumper crop this year. Pepper prices there are currently around \$6,900 a tonne, compared with about \$7,800 in India. Pepper from Vietnam and Brazil could also make inroads into the Indian market if demand continues to rise. Vietnam prices are around \$6,000, while Brazilian pepper is quoted about \$5,800, Shamji said. **CROP SWITCH**
There are also reports of farmers in Idukki switching from pepper to cardamom cultivation in response to the surging cardamom prices. The failure of cardamom production in Guatemala has pushed up the international prices of Indian cardamom, he added.

Women’s share in farm workforce rises, but land access lags, says Arya.ag report

Gayathri G
Chennai

Nearly 77 per cent of rural working women are now engaged in agriculture, even as women operate only 11.72 per cent of India’s farmed area, highlighting a widening gap between their contribution to agriculture and control over productive assets, according to a report by Arya.ag. The report, *Her Harvest: The Hidden Cost of Women’s Invisible Work in Indian Agriculture*, said women’s share in the agricultural workforce rose from 57 per cent in 2017-18 to more than 64 per

cent in 2023-24. However, nearly 47.7 per cent of women engaged in agriculture were recorded as unpaid helpers on family farms, compared with 20.2 per cent of men. The report attributed the rising participation of women partly to men’s migration to cities and non-farm employment. The disparity is also evident in land ownership and access to resources. Women operate just 11.72 per cent of the farmed area despite accounting for more than 64 per cent of the agricultural workforce. Land ownership determines access to formal credit,

extension services and procurement opportunities, the report said. **PRODUCTIVITY GAP**
Women farm workers earn about ₹82 for every ₹100 earned by men in agrifood work. The report cited an estimated 24 per cent productivity gap between women’s and men’s farms of similar size, attributing it to unequal access to credit and inputs rather than differences in ability. Applying the FAO’s estimated 2.5-4 per cent output loss from gender disparities to India’s agricultural GVA of ₹48.7 lakh crore, the report

estimated that the country could be losing ₹1.2-2 lakh crore in agricultural output annually. Equal access to resources could raise yields on women-run farms by 20-30 per cent, while overall agricultural output could increase by 2.5-4 per cent, it said. The report identified a cycle in which women who are not formally recognised as farmers have limited access to institutional credit, inputs and storage, forcing them into distress sales and keeping incomes low. Warehouse receipts, farmer producer organisations and technology could help break this cycle, it said.

‘Global basmati market shifting to premium quality’

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

The global basmati market is shifting towards premium quality as consumers are no longer viewing fragrant rice simply as a staple, according to Aman Gupta, Managing Director, SSIEL (Shiv Shakti Interglobe Exports Pvt Ltd). “They are becoming more conscious of the variety, origin, grain quality, aroma, ageing and cooking characteristics. Along with these factors, the reputation and credibility of the manufacturer are becoming equally important,” Gupta, whose firm is present in over 72 countries, told *businessline*. India holds a strong position globally as basmati is intrinsically associated with the country. The next opportunity would be to strengthen the position through branding, quality assurance, traceabil-

“
We need to tell the story of Indian basmati — its geographical origin, heritage, unique aroma and grain characteristics
AMAN GUPTA
MD, SSIEL



ity and greater consumer awareness, he said. **NEED TO TELL STORY**
“We need to tell the story of Indian basmati better — its geographical origin, heritage, unique aroma and grain characteristics,” said Gupta, who is the third generation in the family to continue with the rice business. Retailers and food companies across the world are keen on traceability, consistency, food safety, pesticide residue and quality in Indian basmati rice. Buyers

in developed markets, in particular, expect suppliers to meet their stringent food safety standards. “Another trend we see is the growth of private label and packaged rice. This gives Indian exporters an opportunity to move higher up the value chain rather than competing purely on price,” he said. **SIGNIFICANT SCOPE**
SSIEL, which has been in the rice business for nearly 6 decades, looks at compliance across the entire value

chain rather than treating it as a final stage exercise. In the domestic market, Gupta believes there is significant scope to raise awareness of authentic basmati. “We can take it beyond traditional consumption occasions and highlight its versatility through modern retail, e-commerce, food service and ready-to-cook formats,” he said. India has a middle-class population of around 430 million, which represents a significant consumer base with strong purchasing power. “This is larger than the entire population of the US and is an important contributor to India’s economic growth. As this segment continues to expand, it is likely to play an important role in driving demand for premium products, including high-quality and authentic basmati rice,” said the Managing Director of SSIEL, which has a presence in all five continents.

**AMARA RAJA | ENERGY & MOBILITY**

AMARA RAJA ENERGY & MOBILITY LIMITED

Registered office: Renigunta - Cuddapah Road, Karakambadi, Tirupati, Andhra Pradesh - 517520.
Corporate Office: Terminal A, 1-18/1/AMR/NR, Nanakramguda, Gachibowli, Hyderabad - 500032.
E-mail id: investor@amararaja.com, Website: www.amararajaandm.com
Tel: 91 (40) 23139000, Fax: 91 (40) 23139001, CIN: L31042AP1985PLC005305

NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS

TRANSFER OF UNCLAIMED DIVIDEND AMOUNT(S) AND/OR UNDERLYING SHARES OF THE COMPANY TO INVESTOR EDUCATION AND PROTECTION FUND (IEPF) AUTHORITY

Notice is hereby given to the shareholders of Amara Raja Energy & Mobility Limited ("the Company"), pursuant to the provisions of Section 124(6) of the Companies Act, 2013 ("the Act") read with Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (Accounting, Audit, Transfer and Refund) Rules, 2016 (as amended) as under:

The Act and Rules, amongst other matters, contain provisions for the transfer of all shares in respect of which dividend has remained unpaid or unclaimed by the shareholders for a period of seven (7) consecutive years or more to the demat account of IEPF Authority (IEPFA).

In this regard, this is to bring to your kind attention the shares of the shareholders whose dividends are lying unclaimed/ unpaid for seven (7) consecutive years from the date of payment of:

i. Interim Dividend I for 2019-20 are due for transfer to IEPF on December 9, 2026;
ii. Interim Dividend II for 2019-20 are due for transfer to IEPF on April 9, 2027.

The Company is in process of sending individual notices to the concerned shareholders, whose above-mentioned dividends are lying unpaid or unclaimed, that their underlying shares are also liable to be transferred to IEPFA, advising them to claim the dividends on or before November 30, 2026.

A list containing the details of such shareholders i.e., Name, Folio No., DP ID and Client ID and no. of shares due for transfer to the IEPFA is also available on the website of the Company i.e., www.amararajaandm.com for information and necessary action by the Shareholders.

The shareholders who have not claimed their dividends from the financial year 2019-20 onwards are requested to immediately claim by written application to M/s. Cameo Corporate Services Limited (RTA), along with the following documents at the earliest, so as to reach them on or before November 30, 2026.

· Letter duly filled in and signed by the shareholder
· Self-attested copy of PAN Card and Address proof
· Original cancelled cheque
· Client master report (in case of shares held in demat mode)

In the event a valid claim is not received on or before November 30, 2026, the Company will proceed to transfer the Equity Shares underlying such unclaimed/unpaid dividend, to IEPFA without any further notice as detailed below:

In case you hold shares in physical form: Shares will be transferred to IEPFA after following the prescribed process and the original share certificate(s) which now stand registered in your names and held by you, will stand automatically cancelled.

In case you hold shares in electronic form: Your Demat account will be debited for the shares liable for transfer to the IEPFA.

Please note that upon transfer, the concerned shareholder can claim both, the unclaimed dividend amount and the shares from the IEPFA by making an application in the prescribed web Form IEPF-5 available on the website https://www.mca.gov.in/content/mca/global/en/mca/iepf-related-services.html and sending the physical copy of the same, duly signed (as per the specimen signature recorded with the Company), along with the requisite documents enumerated in the web Form IEPF-5 to the Nodal Officer at the Corporate Office address of the Company. No claim shall lie against the company in respect of unclaimed dividend and equity shares transferred to IEPFA.

In case of any queries, the concerned shareholders may please contact the Registrar and Transfer Agent of the Company viz; Cameo Corporate Services Limited, Subramanian Building, No.1, Club House Road, Chennai - 600 002, Phone: 044 - 4002 0700, e-mail: cameo@cameoindia.com . Emails may also be sent to investor@amararaja.com.

The shareholders can also upload the documents over the portal of RTA: https://wisdom.cameoindia.com/

For Amara Raja Energy & Mobility Limited

Place: Hyderabad
Date: September 11, 2026

Sd/-
Vikas Sabharwal
Company Secretary & General Counsel

CM YK A CH-CHE

QUICKLY.

Forex reserves rise to a new high of \$785 billion

Mumbai: The country's forex reserves jumped by a record \$44.903 billion to a new lifetime high of \$785.706 billion during the week ended September 4, the RBI said on Friday. In the previous reporting week, the overall reserves increased \$11.475 billion to a new all-time high of \$740.803 billion. For the week ended September 4, foreign currency assets rose \$47.498 billion to \$648.168 billion, the central bank's data showed. **PTI**

Inbound Aerospace to outsource launch infra

Chennai: IIT Madras-incubated spacetech start-up Inbound Aerospace has signed an MoU with Australia-based Space Angel Group to collaborate on reusable spacecraft recovery and mission-support capabilities. Inbound will use Space Angel's launch infrastructure, test-range, recovery infrastructure to test and demonstrate its spacecraft and re-entry capabilities. **OUR BUREAU**

US retains top spot as India's LPG supplier for fifth month in a row

LOGISTICS SHIFT. It accounted for more than 73% of India's LPG imports during August, up from 8% in Feb

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

Persistent disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz (SoH) severely mauled India's liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) supply chain, forcing the world's second largest consumer to tap the US, which supplied almost 75 per cent of the country's import of the key cooking fuel in August.

Washington, which was India's fifth largest LPG supplier till January 2026, jumped a spot to become the fourth largest, replacing Kuwait a month later. Fresh conflict in West Asia (from February 28) propelled the US to become the top supplier for five consecutive months, beginning March. India imported about 0.62 million tonnes (mt) of LPG from the US in August, after



RAPID GROWTH. Washington's share increased from 8 per cent in February 2026 to 16 per cent and 32 per cent in March and April respectively, Equirus said **REUTERS**

bringing in 0.89 mt in July, the OPEC said on Friday. "The US accounted for more than 73 per cent of India's LPG imports during August. Importing from the US is part of a wider supply-side strategy to ease supply bottlenecks imposed by ongoing geopolitical tensions curtailing LPG supply to the country," it added. However, this diversification has come at a cost.

The US LPG is linked to Mont Belvieu prices (\$0.68 per gallon in August 2026, equivalent to around \$360 per tonne) which is generally benched lower than Saudi CP, but longer voyages to India raises the delivered cost, Equirus Securities pointed out. "Houston-Asia VLGC freight exceeded the \$200 per tonne mark in mid-April 2026 and continued to rise to

around \$300 in August as stronger eastbound demand tightened vessel availability. Consequently, US-to-Asia LPG flows declined from around 4.8 mt in July to roughly 4.2 mt in August and are estimated to fall further to 3.6 mt in September," the brokerage added. Meanwhile, constrained regional supply pushed Saudi Arabia's September propane contract price up by \$5 per tonne to \$625. Higher sourcing costs are expected to continue to accumulate with Indian oil marketing companies (OMCs), it noted.

DIVERSIFY SUPPLY Prior to the outbreak of conflict in West Asia in February 2026, India used to import about 60 per cent of its LPG consumption, out of which about 90 per cent transited the SoH. With its closure,

supplies of imported LPG were severely constrained. Before the Hormuz disruption, West Asia supplied more than 90 per cent of India's LPG imports. Washington's share increased from 8 per cent in February 2026 to 16 per cent and 32 per cent in March and April, respectively, Equirus said. "The shift primarily reflects the loss of Gulf supplies. UAE deliveries fell to around 0.14 mt in August, Qatar supplied only around 0.06 mt and Saudi Arabia supplied no LPG during July-August," it pointed out. Imports from Algeria began in June and were expected to reach around 0.11 mt in August. Indian Oil Corporation has finalised a 2027 agreement with Sonatrach for one 45-55 (kilo tonne) kt cargo per month, equivalent to around 0.5-0.7 mt annually, Equirus said.

RBI has enough tools to mop up liquidity surge: Malhotra

Bloomberg



Sanjay Malhotra, RBI Governor

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has enough tools to absorb the record surge in liquidity in the banking system following its massive foreign currency deposit drive, Governor Sanjay Malhotra said on Friday, as policymakers seek to prevent the cash glut from pushing borrowing costs lower and fueling inflation. The RBI will use all available measures to withdraw surplus funds, Malhotra said in an interview with **CNBC TV18**. "We are alert to that. We have enough tools," he said, citing open-market operations and swaps. "Nothing is off the table," he said.

The Governor, however, ruled out raising the cash reserve ratio to absorb liquidity created by the foreign-currency deposits. The comments come as the central bank has begun draining cash from the financial system, including through variable reverse repo auctions and currency swaps. Minutes of the central bank's August meeting showed that policymakers were already turning more hawkish. The RBI's next monetary policy meeting is scheduled for October 5-7. India's excess banking liquidity recently hit a record ₹11 lakh crore (\$115 billion). The deluge followed a \$127 billion inflow from the country's vast diaspora, surpassing even the most optimistic estimates and giving policymakers a bigger war chest to defend the currency. Liquidity has risen in the banking system as lenders swapped their dollars with the central bank in exchange for rupees. On Friday, the RBI rejected some bids at a sale of shorter-maturity debt, a rare occurrence, which market players interpreted as a sign of the authority's discomfort with

investors demanding higher yields from government bonds. Malhotra also pushed back against estimates that the deposit drive will prove costly, saying the inflows will instead generate additional income. Analysts estimate the foreign fund raising to cost the RBI as much as \$10.6 billion over a five-year period.

GROWTH RISKS Malhotra said the RBI's monetary policy stance is "appropriate," with no signs of "overheating even in the consumption loans." The central bank was also "not entirely surprised" by stronger-than-expected growth in the April-June quarter, he said. Incoming corporate data is pointing to firmer growth as well. "The Indian economy has weathered this shock really well," the Governor said. India's economy grew 7.8 per cent in the April-June quarter, data released last month showed, exceeding analysts' expectations and the RBI's own forecast, though questions remain over how fully the headline numbers reflect growth on the ground. Higher energy prices add another risk to the outlook. Crude oil has climbed above \$100 a barrel, a key concern for India, which imports about 90 per cent of its crude requirements. A sustained rise in prices could fuel inflation and weigh on growth. India's retail inflation is expected to edge higher in the coming months, with data due on Monday forecast to show consumer prices rising to 4.86 per cent in August from 4.45 per cent in July.

Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 2026, to take effect from October 1

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The Finance Ministry has set October 1 as the implementation date for the Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 2026. The Act replaces a 125-year-old law with one that preserves access to banking evidence while protecting banks from unnecessary legal proceedings, shifting the emphasis to better-targeted judicial oversight rather than unrestricted access to banking records.

DIGITAL REALITIES

It has been enacted against the backdrop of the rapid expansion of digital banking

and the sharp rise in cyber-enabled financial frauds, including online scams and so-called "digital arrest" cases. A key feature of the new law is the introduction of the concept of "special cause", under which a court may, by a written order, compel a bank officer to produce bankers' books or appear as a witness in proceedings where the bank itself is not a party. The provision raises the threshold for summoning bank officials, ensuring they are not routinely drawn into litigation merely because they hold customer records. The Act defines "special cause" to include circumstances where the accuracy



The law has been enacted against the backdrop of digital banking and the rise in cyber frauds

gital, virtual, cloud-based or any other form, creating a technology-neutral legal framework that can accommodate future advances in banking. To facilitate the use of electronic evidence, the Act provides for standardised certification formats and permits authentication through manual, digital or electronic signatures. It ex-

pressly recognises the admissibility of electronic banking records. Such records may be produced before courts in either physical or electronic form. Another enabling provision empowers the Central Government to extend the legislation's applicability to other entities or classes of entities operating in the financial sector, subject to prescribed conditions. This gives the law flexibility to cover new categories of regulated financial institutions as the sector evolves.

BALANCING ACCESS

This Act seeks to balance two objectives: preserving in-

vestigators' and courts' access to banking evidence in legitimate cases, while reducing unnecessary legal burdens on banks and creating a legal framework suited to India's digital financial ecosystem. The Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 1891 enacted in the era of paper-based banking, allowed certified copies of bank records to be used as evidence in legal proceedings. However, "with the advent of digital banking and electronic record-keeping, the existing legal framework no longer adequately reflects contemporary banking practices," a Finance Ministry official said.

Operation Sindoor exposed gaps in satellite revisit time: DRDO scientist

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

At a time when India is gearing to launch a constellation of 52 surveillance satellites, a senior DRDO scientist said that during Operation Sindoor, India deployed 10 satellites but was still dependent on foreign data. MSY Siva Prasad, 'Outstanding Scientists (R)' with the Defence Research and Development Organisation, stated that lessons of Operation Sindoor should not be forgotten. "While 10 satellites, like the carto satellites, were used, we had to supplement the information with foreign data and foreign sources," said Prasad, who was the project director of both KAUTILYA and RUDRAM2 air-to-surface anti-radiation missile. "The reason was not the resolution. The reason was persistency. We did not have a continuous monitoring of

the area," he explained, adding that a country cannot afford to have a revisit time of six to eight hours image the same geographic spot. Addressing a roundtable discussion on "A Seamless Digital Sky The Next Strategic Atmosphere: A BRICS+ Bilateral Event", hosted by The Synergia Foundation & Russia's Agency for Strategic Initiative, he also suggested that "We absorb outcomes from the Russia-Ukraine and West Asia wars for better space understanding."

LESSONS LEARN'T According to him, the Russia-Ukraine war lent credence to the importance of sovereignty and control over space assets. Prasad said, "We have seen a privately-owned constellation became the neuro-system of the entire war. And, if a foreign government regulates it or the CEO takes a decision to go off the ser-

vice, what kind of situation can come... we saw that." It served as a stark warning to governments about outsourcing critical defence infrastructure to the commercial sector, he said. On the other hand, the US-Israel-Iran conflict showed the importance of resilience. The GPS denied environment or jamming or spoofing is a serious concern not only for military applications but for civilian applications too. "A nation can have a strong military and secure borders, but if its power grids, financial markets, cellular networks or flight systems, which rely heavily on satellites, are vulnerable to foreign influence, it cannot be a truly sovereign nation," he remarked. He urged industry to work on missile launch detecting systems, which India lacks in an era of rapidly leaning toward contactless and cognitive warfare.

TN to go digital for driving licences, RCs from September 13

Press Trust of India
Chennai

Tamil Nadu will completely phase out physical Driving Licences and Vehicle Registration Certificates (RCs) in favour of fully digital issuances starting from September 13, the State government said. Citizens can download digital DLs and RCs immediately upon passing their driving test or completing vehicle registration. The major shift toward digital governance follows an official announcement made by Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on September 2 under Rule 110 on the floor of the Assembly. All digital documents will feature embedded QR codes linked directly to government databases via the mParivahan and DigiLocker platforms.

EV 2W start-up BGauss crosses 1 lakh sales

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

It took nearly four years for Hemant Kabra, Managing Director of Mumbai-based electric two-wheeler start-up BGauss, to take the company past 1 lakh cumulative retail sales. He now plans to cover almost half that journey again in a single year, targeting close to 50,000 units more by the end of FY27 as strong electric two-wheeler demand and growing acceptance of premium scooters encourage the company to widen its portfolio. India's electric two-wheeler market is expanding rapidly, with August 2026 registrations reaching about 1.84 lakh units, up 67.6 per cent year-on-year. EVs now account for nearly 11 per cent of total two-wheeler retail sales, up from 7.7 per cent a year earlier. Against that backdrop, Kabra on Wednesday unveiled the C12 MaxR electric scooter at



Hemant Kabra, Managing Director of BGauss

₹1.45 lakh. "Once your platform is ready, once your motor platforms are ready, then your go-to-market strategy becomes faster," Kabra told **businessline**, outlining the company's next phase of growth. Positioned at the premium end of BGauss' portfolio, the C12 MaxR gets a 3.8-kWh LFP battery with a certified range of 178 km, peak output of 4.2 kW and a top speed of more than 75 kmph. It also debuts BGauss' HyperZen in-wheel motor system, integrating the motor, transmission, braking hardware and motor-control unit and eliminating a conventional belt or chain drive. The scooter offers three ride

modes, reverse and cruise control, a 5-inch TFT display and 38 litres of storage.

CHASING TOP-FIVE BGauss sold 25,320 vehicles between January and August 2026, already surpassing its entire CY2025 sales of 25,131 units. August registrations nearly tripled year-on-year to 5,044 units from 1,729, lifting market share to 2.7 per cent from 1.6 per cent. Kabra said demand remains strong enough to support the next leg of growth, with BGauss scooters currently seeing waiting periods of close to a month. The company is trying to capitalise on that demand through a wider product range and faster development cycles. The C12 MaxR is built on BGauss' modular WSA platform, designed to accommodate different batteries, motors and wheel sizes and underpin future products. "The amount of time you

take to prove the component is way more than the amount of time you take to do the vehicle," Kabra said. Higher volumes are also changing BGauss' sourcing model. Kabra said its Tier-1 supplier base has increased to about 150 from roughly 50 in its early years, while the company is increasingly qualifying multiple suppliers for individual components. "Now we are looking at two, three, or even more suppliers also for one product," he said.

**TO ADVERTISE
PLEASE CONTACT**

Chennai	: 044 - 28576300
Coimbatore	: 0422 - 2212572
Madurai	: 0452 - 2528497
Trichy	: 0431 - 2302801
Puducherry	: 0413 - 2224111

thehindu businessline.

'Supplyco advances Keralam's SDG goals by supporting consumers and farmers'

V Sajeew Kumar
Kochi



Kerala State Civil Supplies Corporation (Supplyco) has emerged a key institution advancing the State's progress towards several sustainable development goals (SDGs), particularly in poverty reduction, food security, livelihood support and reducing inequalities, according to an institutional impact assessment. The study, titled *Supplyco and the sustainable development goals: An institutional impact assessment*, found that Supplyco's combination of welfare provisioning, retail market intervention, farmer procurement and price stabilisation has helped improve the affordability and availability of essential commodities. The assess-

ment, based on a survey of 1,380 households in Thiruvananthapuram, 317 farmers in Palakkad and interviews with 29 vendors and SMEs, examined Supplyco's contribution to SDG 1 (no poverty), SDG 2 (zero hunger), SDG 8 (decent work and economic growth) and SDG 10 (reduced inequalities). More than 90 per cent of the households surveyed reported monthly savings of ₹400-700 through Supplyco's regulated prices. Essen-

tial commodities are often available at prices 20-60 per cent below prevailing market rates, providing an additional layer of social protection.

HOME BUDGET The study noted that Supplyco's universal-access retail network enables households to purchase subsidised essential commodities irrespective of their eligibility under specific welfare categories. This, it said, strengthens household resilience during periods of inflation and economic stress. Supplyco's paddy procurement provides farmers with access to liquidity through a digital procurement receipt sheet-linked credit mechanism and facilitates settlement of minimum support price dues.

Centre mulling private investment in veterinary education to address skill gap

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Mumbai

In a bid to meet the growing demand for veterinary professionals in the country, the government proposes to allow private sector in the veterinary education. There is a huge gap between the veterinary education and the needs of the domestic livestock sector. As the sector grows, there will be a demand for veterinary professionals, said Naresh Pal Gangwar, Secretary, Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying, Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying. "The government is aware of the gap and we are going to come up with schemes where private sector will be incentivised to put in veteri-

nary colleges and I think this gap will be addressed with passage of time," Gangwar said while addressing the 67th National Symposium of the Compound Livestock Feed Manufacturers Association (CLFMA) of India. Over the last 10 years, the livestock sector has grown at a rate of 12 per cent, which is much higher than the annual GDP growth rate. The demand for livestock products is going to grow at a very fast pace as we reach towards Viksit Bharat by 2047, Gangwar said.

FEED INPUT On the volatile trend in the prices of maize and soyabean, the key inputs for the livestock sector, Gangwar said if livestock-related crops offer farmers better returns than traditional crops,

production will gradually shift towards them. Divya Kumar Gulati, Chairman, CLFMA of India said livestock feed sector continues to face challenge with availability and prices of maize and soyabean, the key ingredients for the sector. "Without feed, we cannot grow the poultry sector. The sector is growing at 7-9 per cent annually, and we are already consuming around 30 million tonnes of poultry feed. That means feed demand is increasing by 3-3.5 million tonnes every year. Around 55 per cent of the feed is maize. But maize productivity and availability are a concern," Gulati said, adding that there was a need to find a long term solution.

The writer was in Mumbai at the invitation of CLFMA

adani Power

Adani Power Limited (APL)
Regd. Office: 'Adani Corporate House', Shantigram, Near Vaishno Devi Circle, S. G. Highway, Khodiyar, Ahmedabad 382421, Gujarat, India.

Notice for Limited Auction for 'Sale of Ash' for FY 2026-27 Compliance to Guidelines issued by Ministry of Power (MoP) vide No. 9/8/2024-St. Th. dated 30th January 2026

Expression of Interest (EOI) invited for 'ASH' to be issued from below mentioned Thermal Power Plants of APL including its subsidiaries, to eligible Micro and Small Enterprises (MSEs) & Local MSEs/Local Users engaged in ash-based products manufacturing having valid 'Consent To Operate' (CTO) issued by CPCB / SPCBs or a valid MSE/UDyam registration Certificate and 'Local Users' with (EOI).

1. Korba Power Limited Phase-II, Chhattisgarh (2 X 660 MW)
2. Mahan Energen Limited Phase-II, Madhya Pradesh (2 X 800 MW)
3. Adani Power Limited - Churk, Uttar Pradesh (3 X 60 MW)

Interested parties are requested to submit their annual requirement in (Metric Ton) along with complete Firm/company details on below email address latest by 19.09.2026, 18:00 Hrs.

Email ID: ajeet.singh@auctionit.in

The detailed terms & conditions are available on our auctioneer website: www.auctionit.in Interested parties need to register themselves with Auctioneer.

All corrigendum, addendum, amendments, time extension, if any, shall be updated on the website www.adanipower.com under Commercials Tab. No corrigendum will be published in the press.

e-Auction date would be communicated to all interested or qualified Users through email.

QUICKLY.
A2B partners with Singapore's FC Jurong

Chennai: Football Club Jurong (FC Jurong) and Adyar Anandha Bhavan (A2B) Singapore have partnered to support the Grassroots initiatives of FC Jurong for the football season 2026-27. A2B will support the FC Jurong Soccer School's programme, and the Jurong team jersey will have the A2B logo on it. The FC Jurong Soccer Schools programme is a youth soccer programme operated by the professional football club FC Jurong at five locations across Singapore. The partnership will help to introduce Jurong fans and audiences to A2B specialities and will host promotional activities at the Jurong East Stadium during the Singapore Premier League.

OUR BUREAU

BMW ready for another price hike next month

New Delhi: BMW Group India on Friday said it will soon hike prices of vehicles across its portfolio, the fourth increase during this calendar year because of continuing high commodity prices and rupee depreciation against the euro. The luxury cars maker has cumulatively hiked prices by around 5 per cent till now for the BMW, MINI brands in its portfolio. "The forex has hit us quite a bit," Hardeep Singh Brar, President and CEO, BMW Group India, said.

OUR BUREAU

Coforge saga: After Chairman Bhatt, Director Singh quits

TALENT HUNT. Vivek Sharma, as interim Chair, will lead search for independent directors

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

In a fresh twist to the ongoing Coforge saga, the IT services firm on Friday said that its Non-Executive Independent Director, DK Singh, has resigned, citing "differences and tensions" between the firm's independent and executive directors.

The development comes after the company confirmed that Om Prakash Bhatt, who resigned as Chairman earlier this week, had withdrawn from the Board a finding that he received a low rating in a board evaluation report (BER).

"Accordingly, he also ceases to be member of the committees of the company with immediate effect. There is no other material reason for his resignation other than the reason stated in his resignation email dated September 10, 2026. He is not a director on the board of any other listed entity and accordingly does not hold membership of any board committee of a listed entity," Coforge said in a filing to BSE.

As interim Chair till January 31, 2026, Vivek Sharma



TRANSPARENCY VOW. The company said that it "remains committed" to ensuring that its governance is transparent

will lead a global search for adding additional independent directors to the board, it said, adding that Sharma will also oversee the process of electing the new Chair, which will consider both existing and newly-appointed directors.

APPROPRIATE DECISION "After careful consideration, I have decided to resign from the Board of Directors of Coforge Ltd, effective immediately. This has not been an easy decision by any means. However, following the unfortunate events of the past several weeks and resignation of the Chairman - OP Bhatt early this week, I believe this is the appropriate decision for me at this time," DK Singh wrote in his resignation letter.

The company also informed the stock exchanges that it will host an 'analyst/investor conference call in

view of the recent developments and address any queries from investors" on Monday.

SUDDEN EXIT In an earlier intimation, the company had informed that the sudden exit of Bhatt was due to him not sharing the complete findings of the BER prepared by the internal auditor with the Board and the Nomination and Remuneration Committee (NRC).

The company, in its fresh clarification, said that the Chairman's category "received the lowest rating" in the BER, but this was not disclosed or discussed before the NRC or the Board when the evaluation findings were presented.

The internal auditor has further observed that the manner in which the evaluation findings were presented (without sharing copies of the Reports), by the Chair-

man of the Board and the NRC Chair, to the NRC and the Board, did not cover all relevant aspects and findings, it said.

The company further said that the internal audit/governance review was ongoing, and the company 'remains committed' to ensuring that its governance processes are transparent.

According to the company, the Board has worked in close cooperation, with all business strategies and governance decisions being approved unanimously, which has enabled it to take key decisions expeditiously.

"These decisions included the divestment of the AdvantageGo business, exit from the data centre business, acquisition of Encora, execution of the Sabre contract and decision to exit the loss-making India government business," it said.

The Noida-based tech company also clarified that it conducted the Board evaluation exercise for the financial year 25-26, as required under applicable regulations and rules adding that the Board evaluation process was entirely distinct from the company's financial reporting and audit processes.

Then & now: Update on last year's winners of Changemaker Awards

Impulse Model enters an era of tech-driven human innovation

2025 WINNER.

Social Transformation

Richa Mishra
Hyderabad

When the Impulse NGO Network was named the *businessline* Changemaker for Social Transformation for the year 2025, the spotlight shone brightly on a framework designed to turn the tide against cross-border human trafficking. Today, that framework is no longer just an award-winning concept. It has evolved into an active lifeline, entering a critical new era where technology, data and human-centred innovation take centre stage.

Driven by its founder Hasina Kharbhih, the Shillong-headquartered organisation has scaled its operations across India, Nepal, Bangladesh, Thailand and Myanmar, and helped over 74,000 survivors.

A close look at where Impulse stands today reveals how a grassroots strategy born in North-East India became a permanent blueprint for cross-border justice and economic freedom. Speaking to *businessline*, Kharbhih reflected on the milestone with a sense of grounded urgency. Being reflective, she said she views the recognition not as a final destination, but rather as a poignant reminder of the responsibility they carry and the distance they still have to travel.

BOLD ROADMAP

Asked about the organisation's next steps, Kharbhih revealed a bold roadmap designed for the coming decade. The core objective is to transition entirely from creating individual interventions to building largescale systems of transformation.

These systems are meant to be fully owned, adapted and scaled by local communities, public institutions, and governments across international borders. Kharbhih pointed out that migration and trafficking do not recognise borders, which means institutional solutions cannot remain confined within them either.

To achieve this global harmony, the next phase of the Impulse Model is intentionally breaking away from traditional administrative methods.

The organisation is introducing data-driven prevention by leveraging tech-driven innovation for the early identification of vulnerabilities and seamless cross-border stakeholder coordination.

However, Kharbhih is quick to clarify that they want to build stronger systems while ensuring that technology never replaces the human connection and dignity that are central



Hasina Kharbhih, Founder, Impulse NGO Network



to their work. Simultaneously, the organisation is shifting its focus towards creating deep economic resilience.

Kharbhih explained that the future is about moving from merely helping communities survive to enabling them to lead their own social and economic transformation.

"This means that sustainable livelihoods, green enterprises, agro-forestry and artisan empowerment will become the primary weapons used to eradicate the root financial vulnerabilities that trigger unsafe migration in the first place. This long-term sustainability relies heavily on a radical restructuring of organisational power through decentralised leadership," she said.

Kharbhih strongly believes that organisations cannot depend on a single founder or just one generation.

FUTURE VISION

She envisions the next decade as a time when more young leaders, trafficking survivors, community heads and local women take absolute ownership of the vision, carrying it forward in ways that may look entirely different from how the journey began.

Impulse's next chapter is about proving that transformative change can become a permanent, borderless movement, by seamlessly weaving together advanced data systems with grassroots economic empowerment.

Landmark India-EU FTA moves a step closer

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The European Commission has formally put forward its proposal to the Council of the European Union for the signature and conclusion of the Free Trade Agreement (FTA) with India, moving the 'mother of all trade deals' a step closer to becoming the largest trade agreement either side has ever signed.

The proposal, tabled by the Commission on Friday, seeks Council authorisation to sign and conclude the pact. If cleared, the agreement will still require the European Parliament's consent and a separate Council decision on conclusion before it enters into force.

Commenting on X, EU ambassador-designate to India Jean-Eric Paquet said: "Fantastic news! EU-India FTA just moved one step closer to the finish line."

The Commission said the EU and India already trade goods and services worth more than €180 billion a year, supporting close to 800,000 EU jobs. Once in force, the agreement will



BOOST TO TIES. European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen with Prime Minister Narendra Modi at the 16th India-EU Summit in New Delhi in January 2026

eliminate or reduce tariffs on 96 per cent of EU goods exports to India, saving European exporters around €4 billion annually in duties. On the Indian side, the deal grants preferential access to 97 per cent of EU tariff lines, covering 99.5 per cent of trade value, with more than 70 per cent of tariff lines seeing immediate duty elimination.

KEY NEGOTIATIONS

Friday's move follows the political conclusion of negotiations on January 27, when Commission President Ursula von der Leyen, European Council President Antonio Costa and Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the deal at the 16th

India-EU Summit in New Delhi.

The talks for this had run, with a near-decade suspension between 2013 and 2022, since 2007. The negotiated text has since undergone legal revision and translation into the EU's official languages ahead of Friday's submission.

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal, who has shuttled between Brussels and European capitals through the year pressing for an early signing, said on September 4 that all 27 EU member states backed the pact, calling the unanimity unusual by the bloc's standards.

"I assure you it has been deftly negotiated, protecting

sensitive sectors on both sides. Therefore, there has been not one murmur of dissent against the India-EU FTA," Goyal had said, addressing an India-Belgium business dialogue in Mumbai.

POLITICAL CONSENSUS

Von der Leyen and Modi had earlier committed, on the sidelines of the G7 Summit in Evian, to sign the agreement by the end of the year and to expand defence co-operation and connectivity initiatives, including the India-West Asia-Europe Corridor.

Because the agreement falls within the EU's exclusive competence on trade, its ratification does not require

separate approval from national parliaments of the 27 member states, unlike mixed agreements that touch on areas of shared competence.

Trade analysts have estimated that once political consensus exists among the Commission, Council and Parliament, as officials on both sides have repeatedly signalled through the year, the remaining approval steps could move relatively quickly, with the full process from signature to entry into force typically taking about a year.

The pact makes the EU India's 22nd FTA partner and is being billed as the EU's largest-ever trade agreement by trade value, with the two economies together accounting for close to a quarter of global GDP. Along with the trade deal, the two sides had also signed a security and defence partnership at the January summit, the EU's third in Asia after Japan and South Korea.

The Council's authorisation, once granted, would clear the way for the formal signing ceremony that both sides have targeted before the close of 2026.

The 10-minute delivery race is over, says UBS analyst Navin Killa

Mahesh Ravidas Nayak
Mumbai

India's obsession with 'quick-commerce' may be missing the bigger picture. According to Navin Killa, UBS's telecom, media and internet analyst, the industry is entering a phase where the distinction between e-commerce and quick-commerce is rapidly disappearing.

For years, quick-commerce players marketed themselves around ultra-fast deliveries. That strategy is losing relevance. "Ten to 15 minute delivery is not the battle any more," Killa said. "The 10-15 minute delivery factor is increasingly becoming a hygiene factor and the battle is now more about assortment."

In his view, consumers are no longer choosing platforms solely because groceries arrive in minutes.

LARGER RANGE

Instead, platforms are competing to become the primary destination for a larger range of purchases.

This shift explains why major e-commerce companies are moving into rapid delivery while quick-commerce firms are expanding their



product offerings beyond groceries.

"The lines are completely blurring," Killa said. "The fact that two of your largest e-commerce companies, (Amazon and Flipkart) have gone into this space is evidence of that."

Killa believes the future marketplace will not be divided between quick-commerce and e-commerce. Instead, it will operate as a continuum of delivery choices.

At one end are deliveries under 60 minutes. In the middle sit traditional deliveries ranging from a few hours to two days. At the value-focused end are platforms where customers wait five to seven days in exchange for lower prices.

The industry's infrastructure is already evolving to

support that model. According to Killa, companies are building multiple categories of dark stores: traditional grocery centres, large assortment warehouses, dedicated pharmaceutical facilities and gourmet-focused locations. Future networks could include specialised electronics centres and category-specific warehouses. As supply chains become more complex, the promise of a universal 10-minute delivery becomes less practical.

GROWTH CHANCES

Importantly, Killa sees growth opportunities across every segment. "Quick-commerce is growing 40-45 per cent. Traditional e-commerce is probably growing 10-15 per cent. Value commerce is growing 25-30 per cent. Nothing is not growing," he said.

That growth profile helps explain why investors continue to assign premium valuations to internet businesses despite profitability concerns.

"The total online retail market in India is growing at about 25-30 per cent," Killa said, adding that India's online penetration remains near 10 per cent of total retail sales, significantly below

more mature digital markets. For investors, the attraction lies in the runway.

While expansion into smaller towns remains a popular theme among internet companies, Killa cautions against overstating its impact.

"The top 15 to 20 cities contribute almost 70 per cent of the total top line," he said. "In the foreseeable future, the top 15 to 20 cities will continue to be the markets that make or break whether you are a good business or a bad business." That does not mean smaller cities are unimportant.

Quick-commerce platforms increasingly serve consumers with limited access to modern retail formats. Many products available through these apps are unavailable through traditional local stores.

As India's online retail market races toward the next phase of growth, the winners may not be the companies that deliver the fastest.

Instead, they are likely to be the platforms that become indispensable destinations for everything consumers want to buy, regardless of whether it arrives in 10 minutes, two hours or two days.

SC seeks FSSAI clarity on red warning label implementation

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

The Supreme Court has sought details from the Centre on the framework for the proposed front-of-the-pack (FOPL) warning labels, including the implementation timeline, how the red hexagonal warning labels will be pictorially represented, and the methodology for calculating thresholds for high fat, sugar, and salt.

The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has been directed to file its response within 10 days.

The Court has sought information on the timeline the food safety regulator envisages for implementing the FOPL regulations, including whether it will initially be voluntary before becoming mandatory.

It has also sought details on how threshold levels for the nutrients of concern, including high fat, high sugar and high salt will be determined.

For fat and sugar, SC asked whether threshold limits will be calculated based on total sugar and saturated fat, and whether trans-fat levels will be factored into the fat-content calculations.



"Assessment of consumer acceptability or giving the industry adequate time for reformulation cannot be reason enough for this uncertainty."

Therefore, a reasonable, scientifically-justified and clearly-defined timeline or transitional period which divides the two phases must be indicated, for the approach of the FSSAI to be a workable one," the order said.

NUTRIENTS CONCERN

It also enquired about the dimensions of the proposed hexagonal warning labels, how and where the proposed 'red hexagon' will be placed, and why the FSSAI has suggested a "combined or singular" hexagon for two or more nutrients of concern.

Raising concerns about rising obesity in school-age children and adolescents,

opted not to seek a third term, starting February 2027.

Last month, Chandrasekaran had announced that he will not seek another term.

Subsequently, the Tata Trusts said it would take steps to form a selection committee to choose the next Chairman as soon as possible. However, the formation of the committee

has not moved forward because of a regulatory ban on the Sir Ratan Tata Trust.

A person aware of the proceedings said there was a discussion on projects related to water conservation and education in the meeting on Friday. However, there was no discussion regarding a search panel or the ongoing probe by the Charity Commissioner of Maharashtra.

Australia looks at deeper space ties with India

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Australia sees scope to deepen space ties with India, including potential collaboration on launch and recovery, even as the two countries expand cooperation in Earth observation, human spaceflight and emerging technologies, said Enrico Palermo, Head of the Australian Space Agency.

"We see India as one of Australia's enduring partners in space," Palermo told *businessline*, citing complementary capabilities in both countries.

Australia committed A\$18 million in 2024 under its International Space Investment India Projects Initiative for three joint missions.

Palermo felt that Australia's sparse population and low-air and maritime traffic make it suitable for space activities.

He said Australia could contribute expertise in robotics and remote operations, ground-segment infrastructure, remote medicine and life sciences for human spaceflight, and optical communications.

For India's Gaganyaan programme, Australia is supporting tracking infrastructure.

